Running a paid campaign

How to set up, open, run and close a Duck Drop or ticket sale on the website, step by step. Written for Contentful editors; no technical knowledge needed.

READ THIS FIRST

How a campaign works

A **campaign** is anything the pantry sells on the website: rubber ducks for the Duck Drop, tickets for a dinner, raffle-style items. Visitors choose how many they want, enter their details, pay by card on a secure Stripe page, and get a confirmation email. Every sale lands in a Google Sheet for the team.



What visitors see: a campaign on the website.

Two kinds of campaign

Type	Use it for	What is special
Numbered	Duck Drop and anything else where each item needs its own number	Every duck gets the next number (1, 2, 3 … or from a start number you choose). Buyers see their numbers right away and in their email. The sheet has one row per duck.
Tickets	Dinners, galas, events	A "family ticket" can count as 4 people toward the event's capacity. The sheet has one row per order, with the number of people.

The four building blocks in Contentful

You build a campaign from four kinds of entries. Each one points to the next:

Page shows a **Campaign Section** which uses a **Campaign** which sells **Campaign Items**

Entry	What it holds	Example
Campaign Item	One thing for sale and its price	Duck, $10 · Family ticket, $100
Campaign	The sale itself: dates, limits, spreadsheet, the buyer's email	Duck Drop 2027
Campaign Section	The form on a page, with a title and intro text	"Adopt a Duck!"
Page	The web address where the form appears	/duck-drop

Before you start, have these ready

- What you are selling and the price of each item.
- When sales open and close (optional).
- Any limits: total available, per order, places held back for sponsors.
- The text for the confirmation email and the thank-you message.

- About 30 minutes, and access to Contentful and the pantry's Google Drive.

Important **Three rules that protect your sales data**

1. Never change a campaign's **Campaign ID** after the first sale. The website counts sales and hands out duck numbers by that ID.
2. In the sales spreadsheet, never rename the first tab (`Sheet1`) and never move or delete the generated columns. You may add your own columns to the right.
3. Always test a new campaign on a hidden page before you link to it (chapter 6).

GOOGLE DRIVE · 5 MINUTES

Create the sales spreadsheet

Every sale is written to a Google Sheet that belongs to the campaign. Create it first, because the campaign needs its ID.

1 Create a new spreadsheet

In Google Drive, open the pantry's shared folder for events (not your personal *My Drive*, so the sheet stays with the pantry). Click **New → Google Sheets → Blank spreadsheet**.

2 Name it

Click *Untitled spreadsheet* at the top left and type a clear name, for example **Duck Drop 2027 – Online Sales**.

Leave the sheet empty and leave the tab at the bottom named `Sheet1`. The website writes the column headings itself when the first sale comes in.

3 Share it with the website

Click **Share** (top right). In "Add people", paste this address and choose **Editor**:

```
donation-sheet-writer@pantry-shoppers.iam.gserviceaccount.com
```

Untick **Notify people** (it is not a real inbox) and click **Share**. This is the website's own account; without it, sales cannot be written to the sheet.

4 Keep it private

In the same Share window, under **General access**, make sure it says **Restricted**. Add the team members who need to see sales. The sheet holds buyers' names, emails and phone numbers.

5 Copy the spreadsheet ID

Look at the address bar. The ID is the long code between `/d/` and `/edit`:

`docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/`**`1XVzgxftbQojfFFfDUR1-ktRVLMTQwrWqg4CPFpfslMc`**`/edit`

Copy just that part. You will paste it into the campaign in chapter 4.

> **Tip** No sheet yet? You can leave the spreadsheet field empty and add it later. Sales are always stored safely, but **only sales made after you add the ID appear in the sheet**. Add it before you open sales.

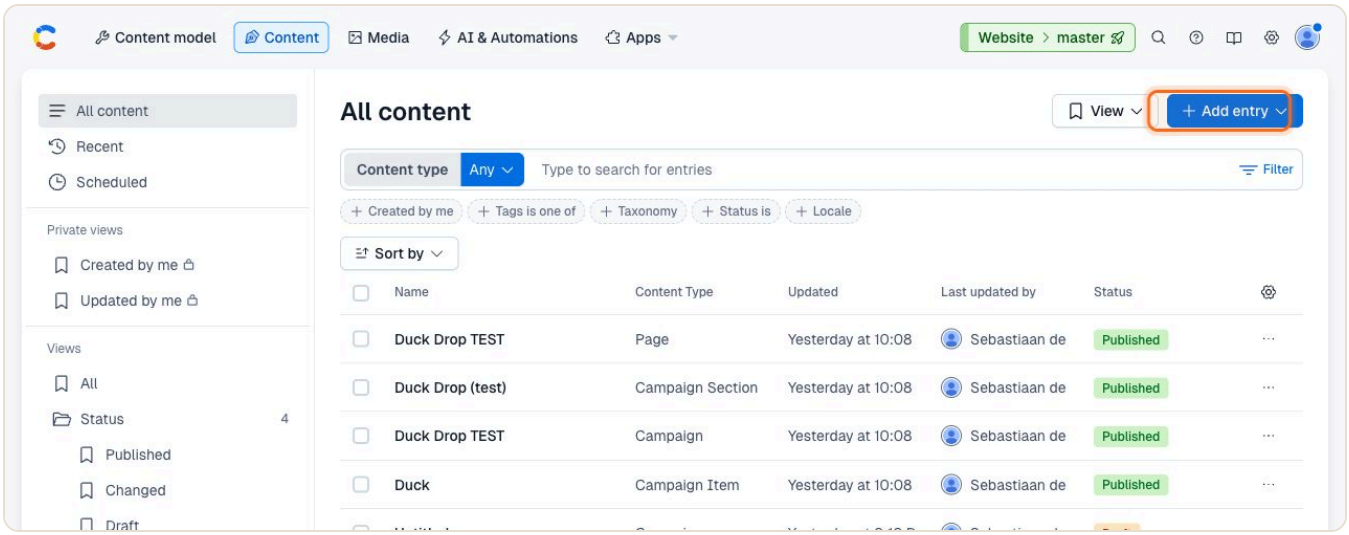
CONTENTFUL · 5 MINUTES PER ITEM

Create the items for sale

Make one **Campaign Item** for each thing a buyer can choose: "Duck", "5-pack of ducks", "Adult ticket", "Family ticket". Items can be reused next year.

1 Start a new entry

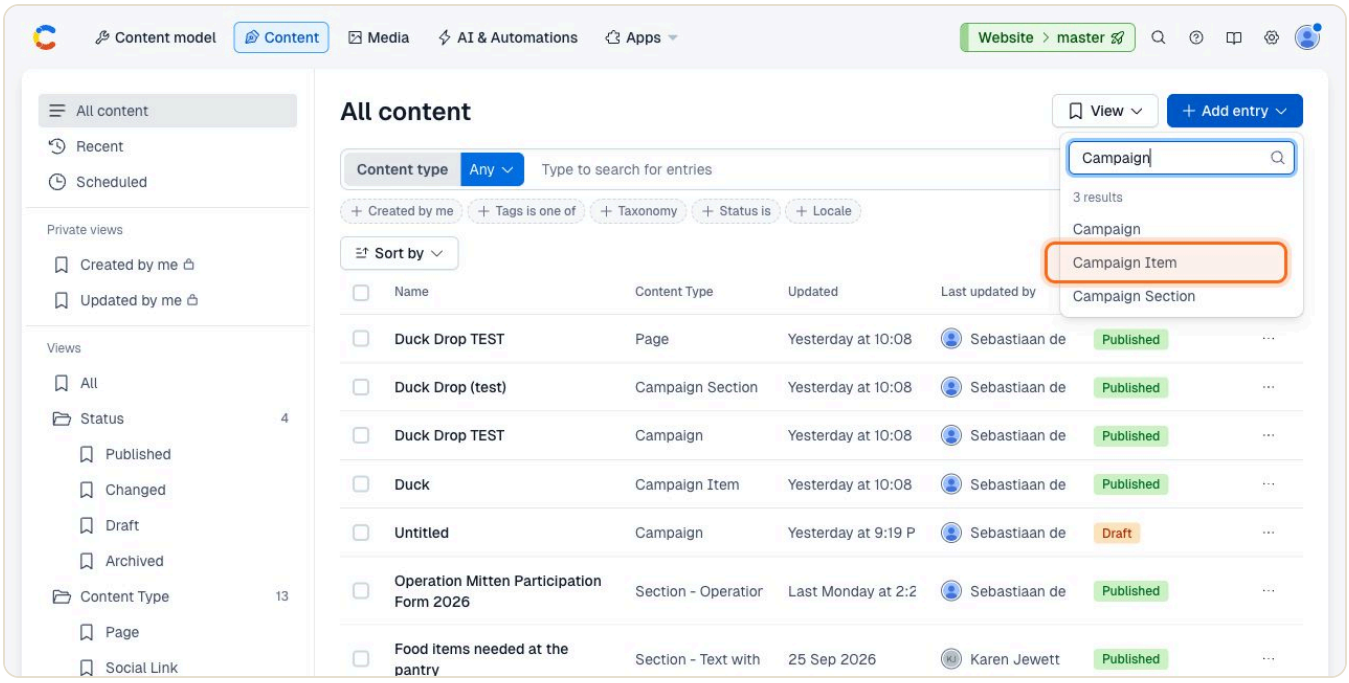
In Contentful, open the **Content** tab and click **Add entry**.



Content tab → Add entry.

2 Choose "Campaign Item"

Type **Campaign** in the search box at the top of the menu to shorten the list, then click **Campaign Item**.

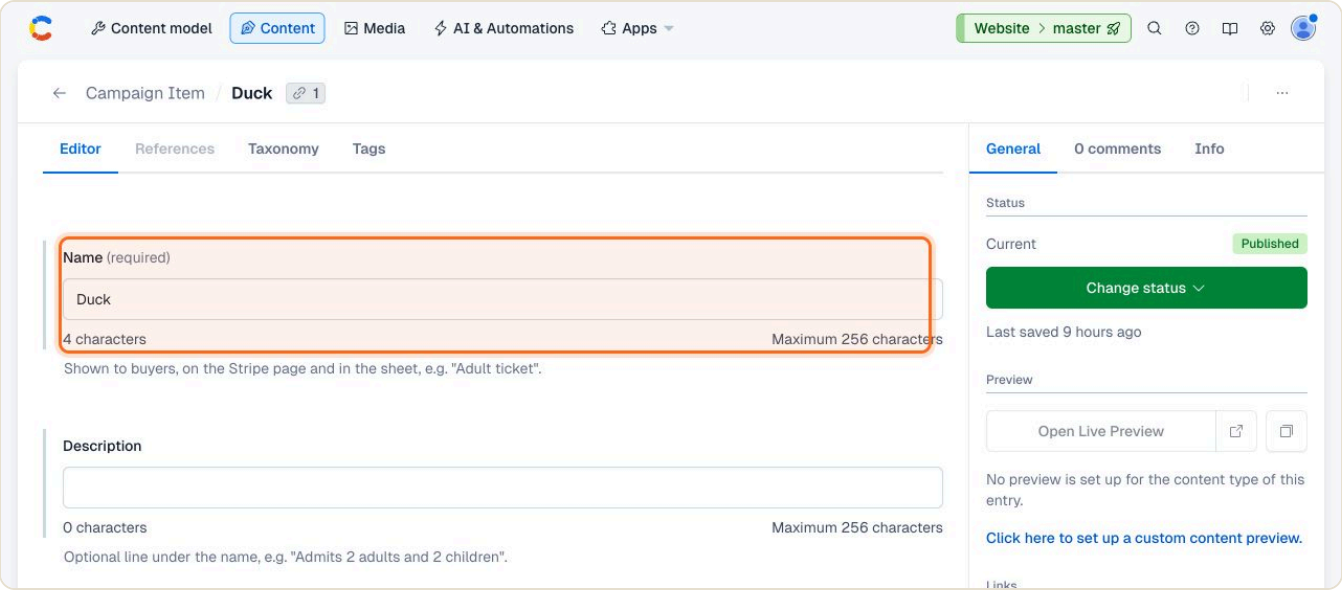


Choose Campaign Item.

3 Name

Type the name buyers will see, for example **Duck** or **Adult ticket**. It also appears on the payment page and in the sheet.

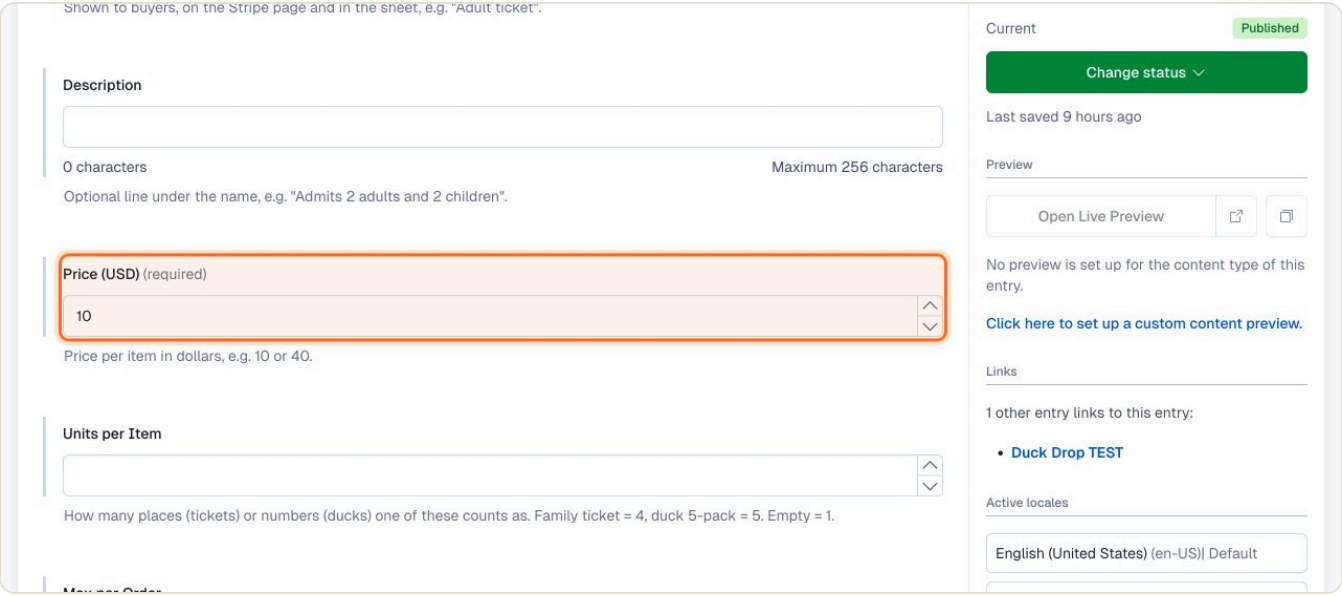
Description (optional) is a short line under the name, such as "Dinner and dessert included" or "Admits 2 adults and 2 children".



The Name field.

4 Price

Enter the price in dollars, numbers only: `10`, `40`, `12.50`.

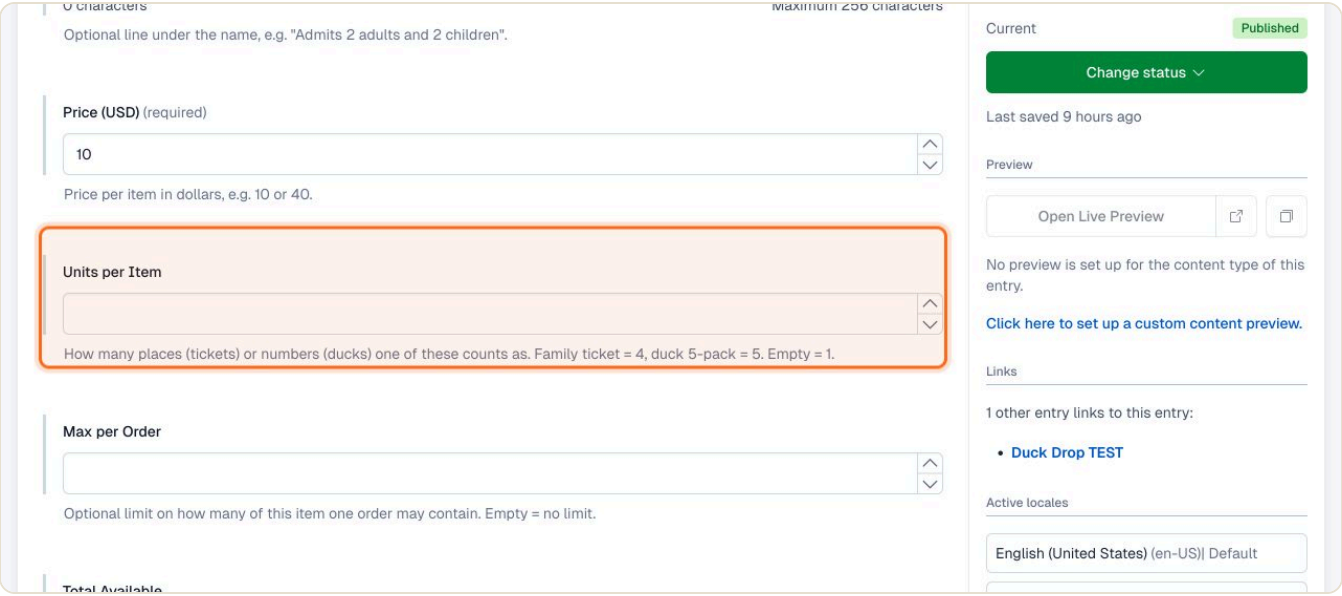


Price (USD).

5 Units per item (only for packs and family tickets)

How many ducks or people this item counts as. Leave empty for a normal item (it counts as 1).

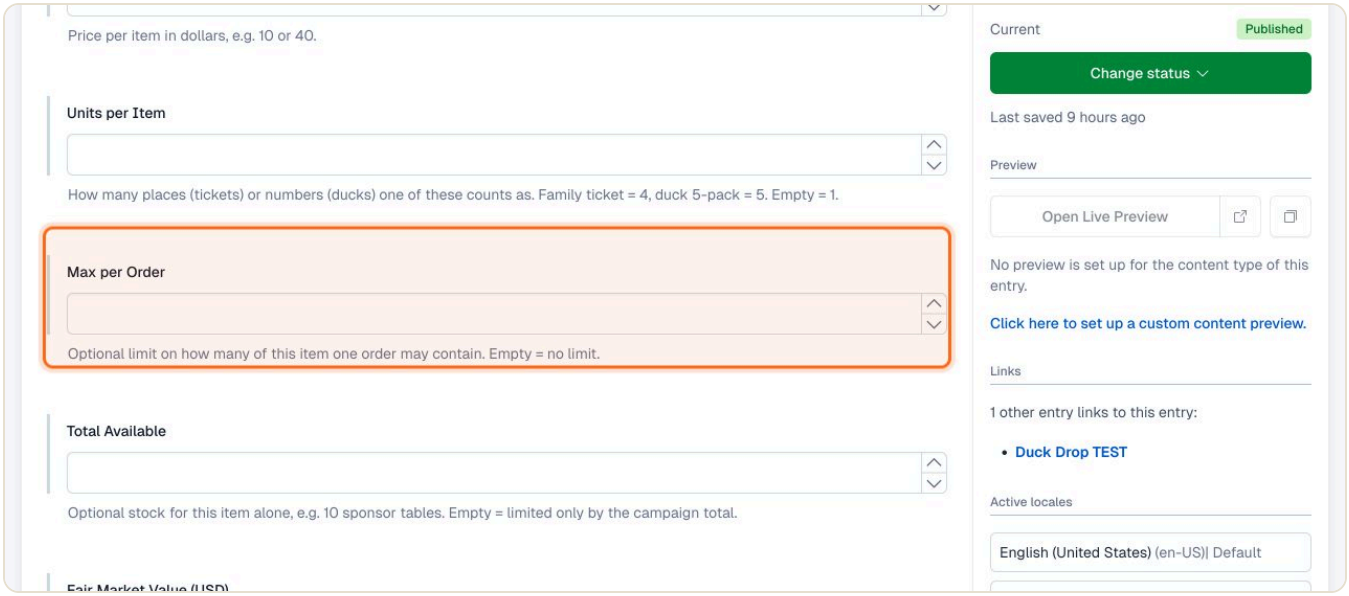
Item	Units per Item	Result
Duck	(empty)	1 duck, 1 number
5-pack of ducks	5	5 ducks with 5 consecutive numbers
Family ticket	4	Counts as 4 people toward the event's capacity



Units per Item.

6 Limits (optional)

Max per Order: the most of this item one buyer can take, for example 10 tickets.
Total Available: stock for this item alone, for example 8 sponsor tables. Leave both empty for no limit.

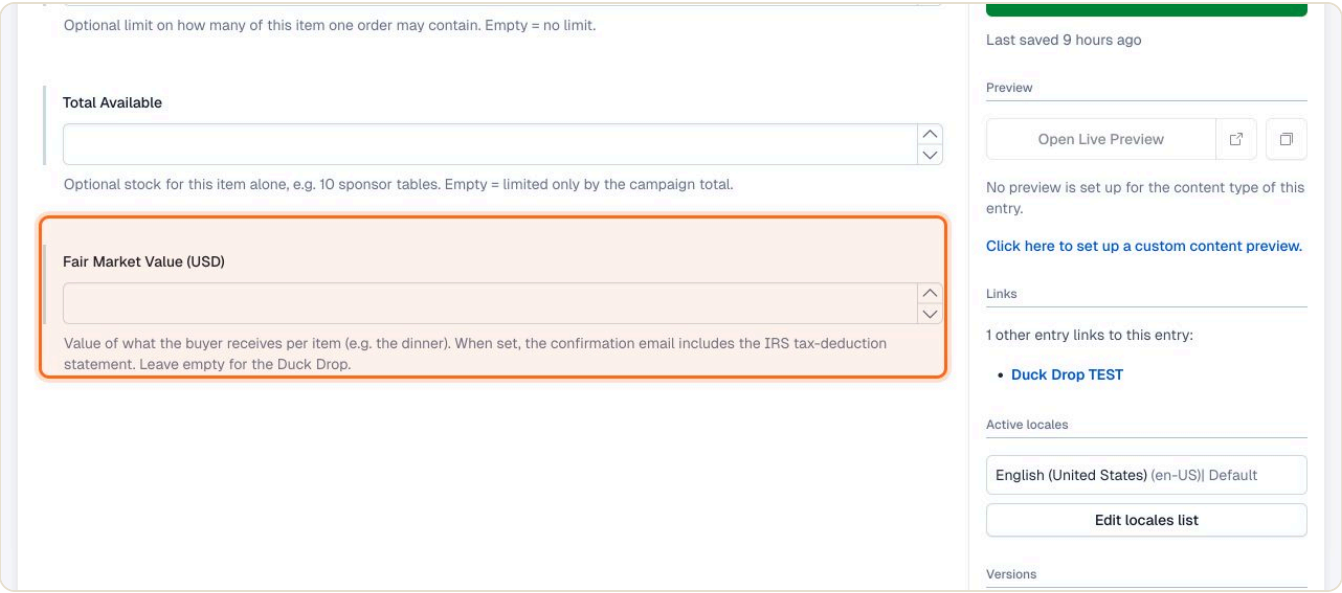


Max per Order and Total Available.

7 Fair market value (tickets with a meal or gift)

If the buyer receives something of value, like dinner, enter its value per ticket here, for example `25` for a $40 dinner ticket. The confirmation email then includes the statement the IRS requires about how much of the payment is tax-deductible.

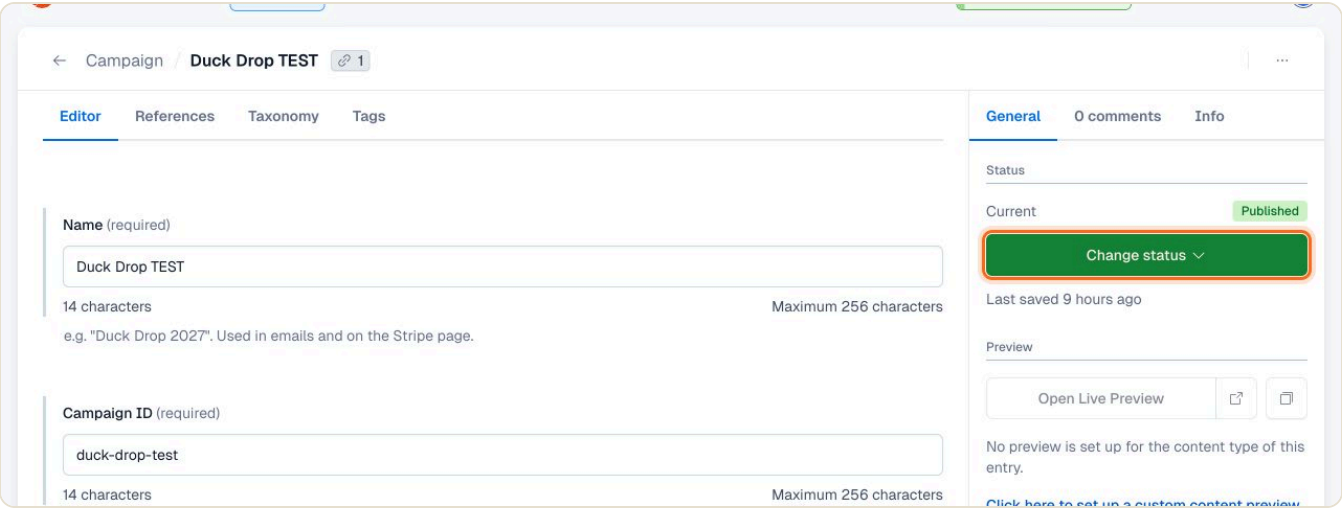
Leave it empty for the Duck Drop.



Fair Market Value (USD).

8 Publish

Click the green **Publish** button on the right. Once an entry is published, that button reads **Change status**; after you edit a published entry it offers **Publish changes**, and your edits only reach the website after you click it. Repeat for each item.



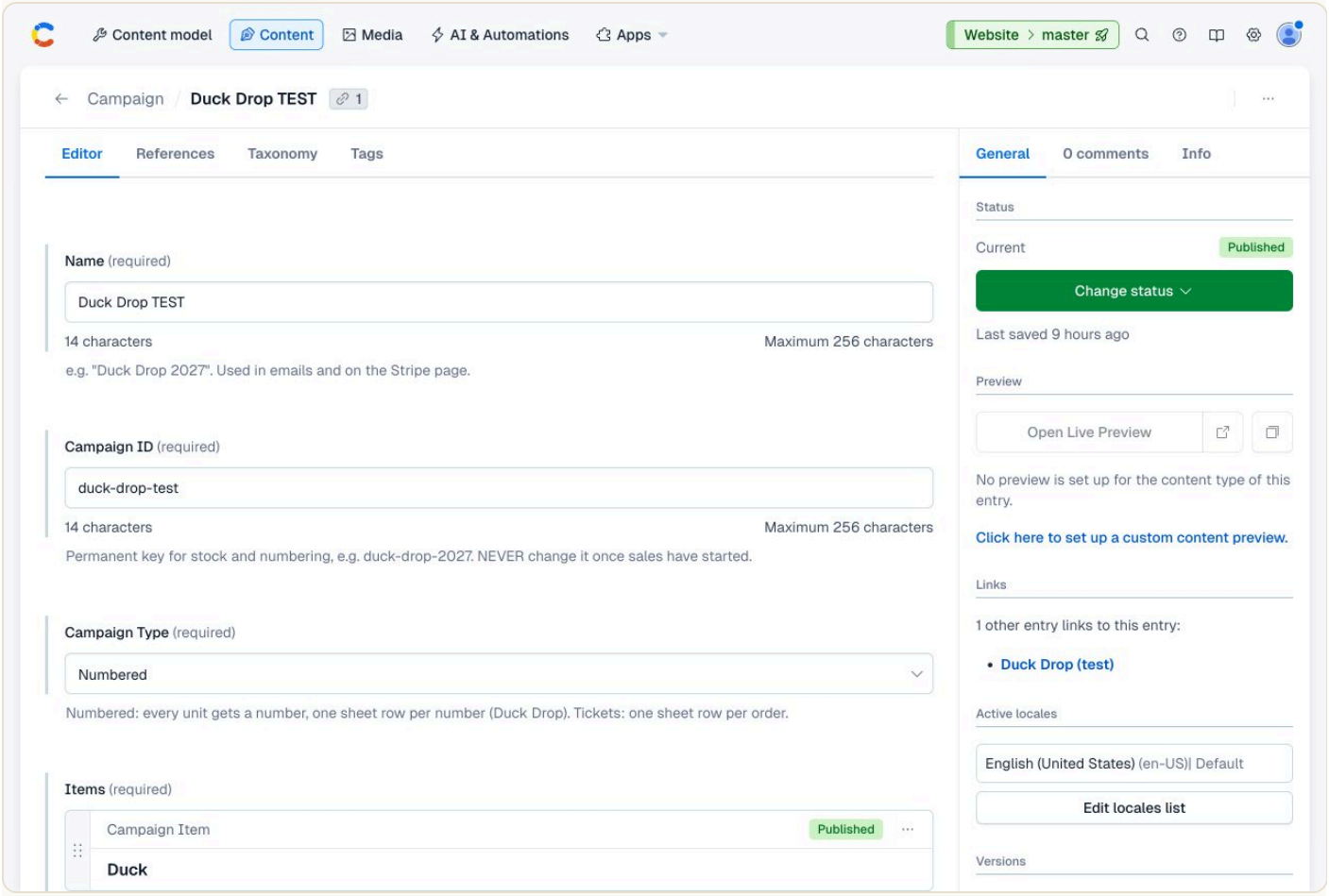
The status button on the right (here on an entry that is already published).

> **Tip** Not sure about the fair market value? Ask the treasurer. A common approach is the cost per person of the meal the venue charges.

CONTENTFUL · 15 MINUTES

Create the campaign

The **Campaign** entry ties everything together: the items, the dates, the limits, the spreadsheet and the email buyers receive. Only the first few fields are required.



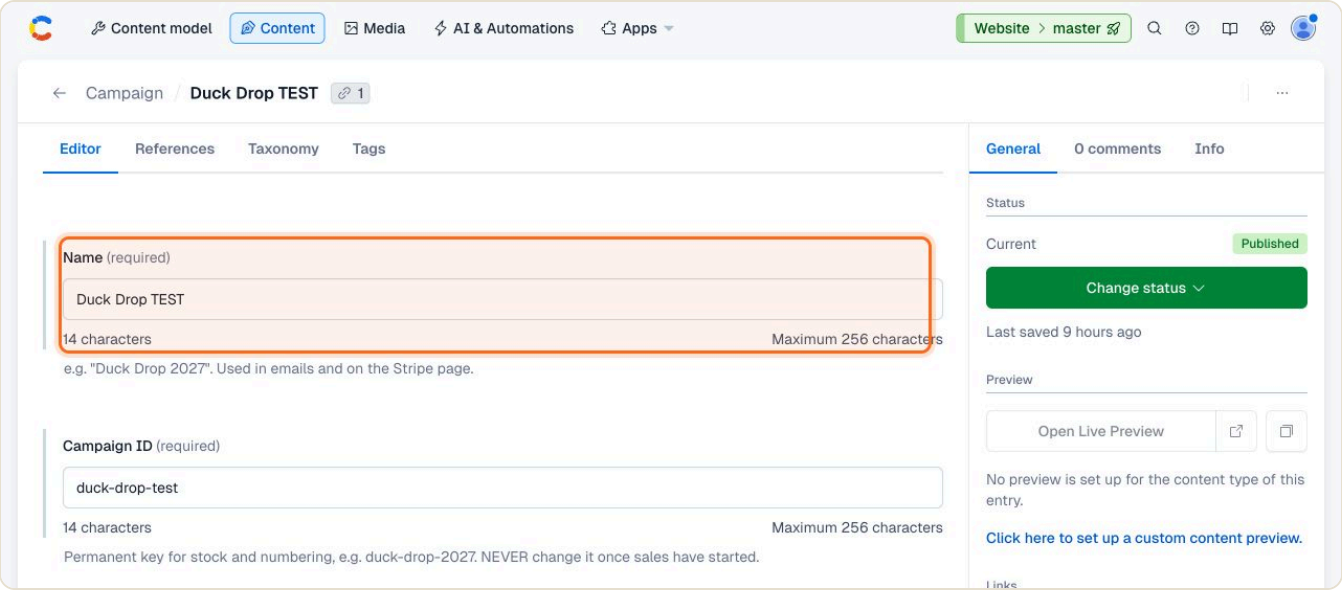
A campaign entry (the Duck Drop test campaign).

1 Start a new Campaign

Content → Add entry → Campaign.

2 Name

The name buyers see on the payment page and in their email, for example **Duck Drop 2027** or **Spring Gala 2027**.

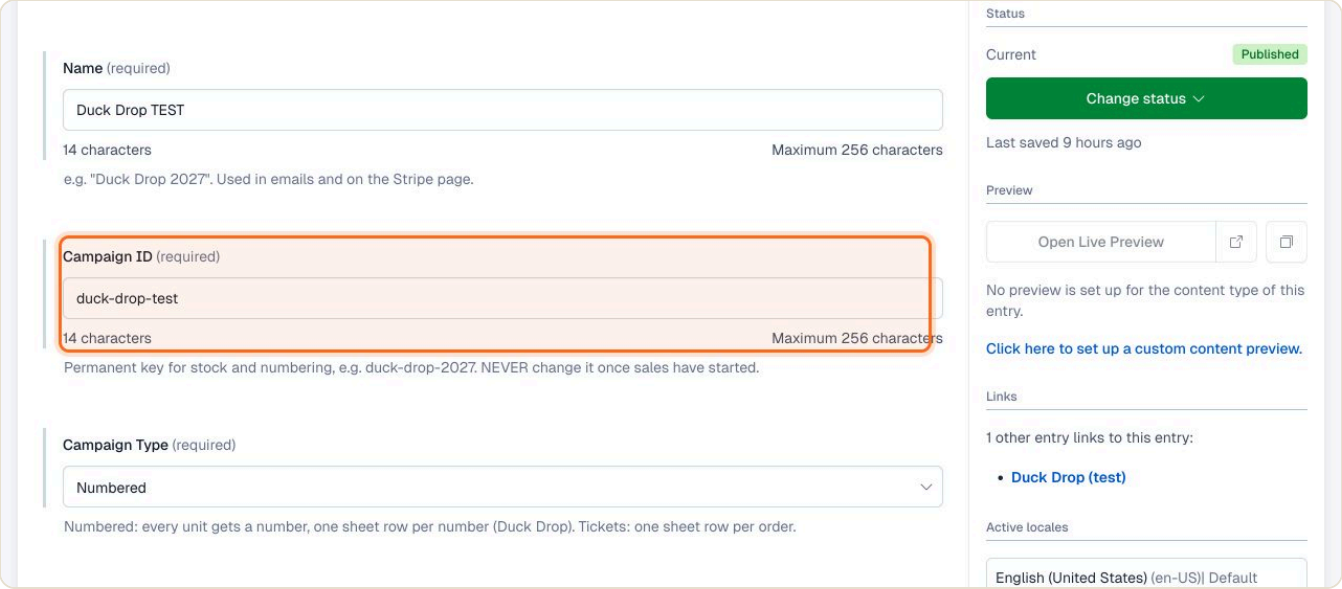


Name.

3 Campaign ID

A short code, lowercase with dashes, for example `duck-drop-2027`. It must be different from every earlier campaign, so include the year.

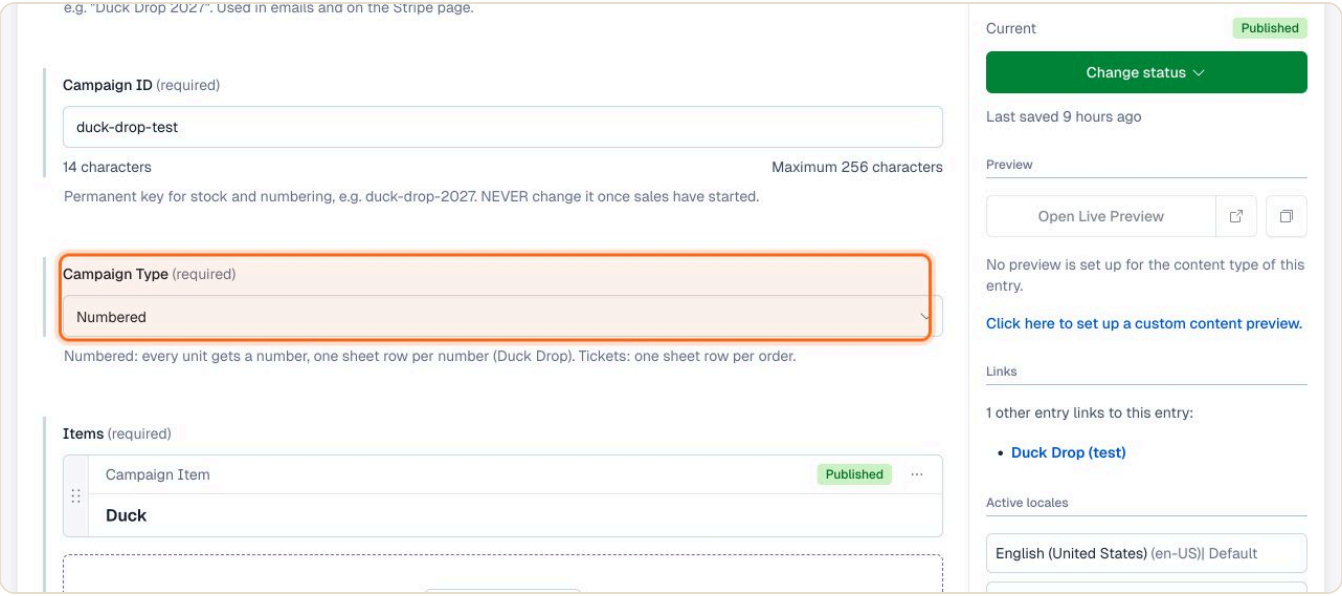
> **Important** Never change the Campaign ID once sales have started. The website keeps count of sales and duck numbers under this ID; a new ID starts from zero.



Campaign ID.

4 Campaign Type

Choose **Numbered** for the Duck Drop or **Tickets** for an event.

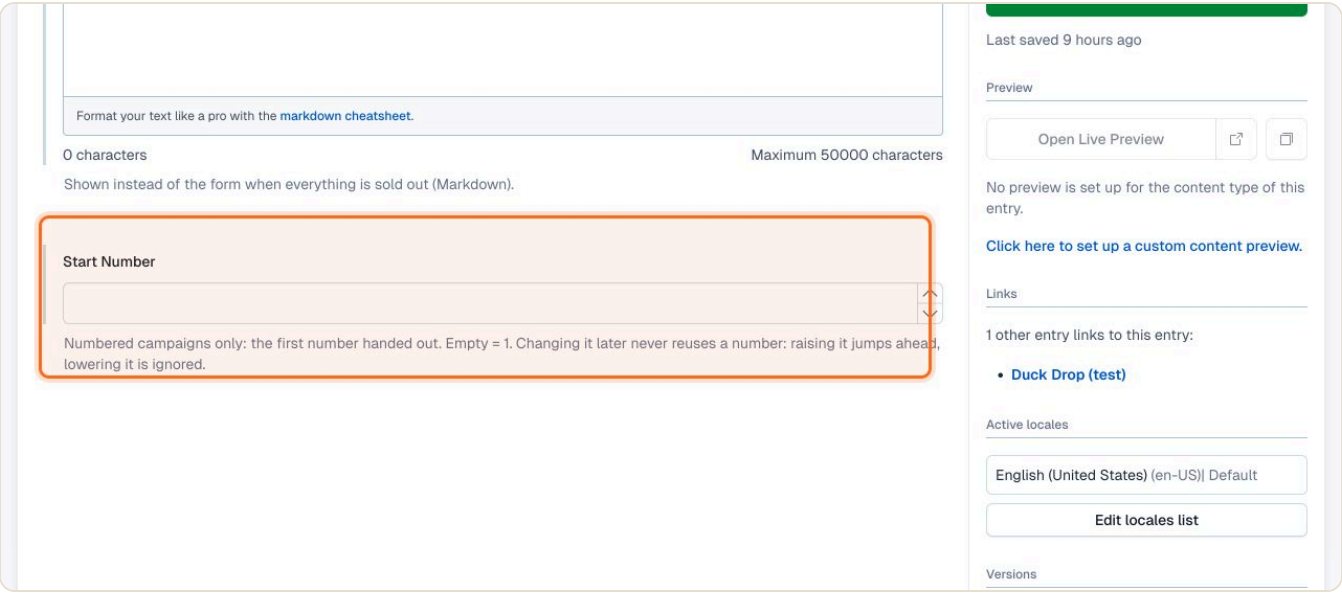


Campaign Type.

5 Start Number (Numbered only)

The number the first duck gets. Leave empty to start at 1. Use it when ducks are also sold on paper: if the paper forms use 1–500, enter `501` here.

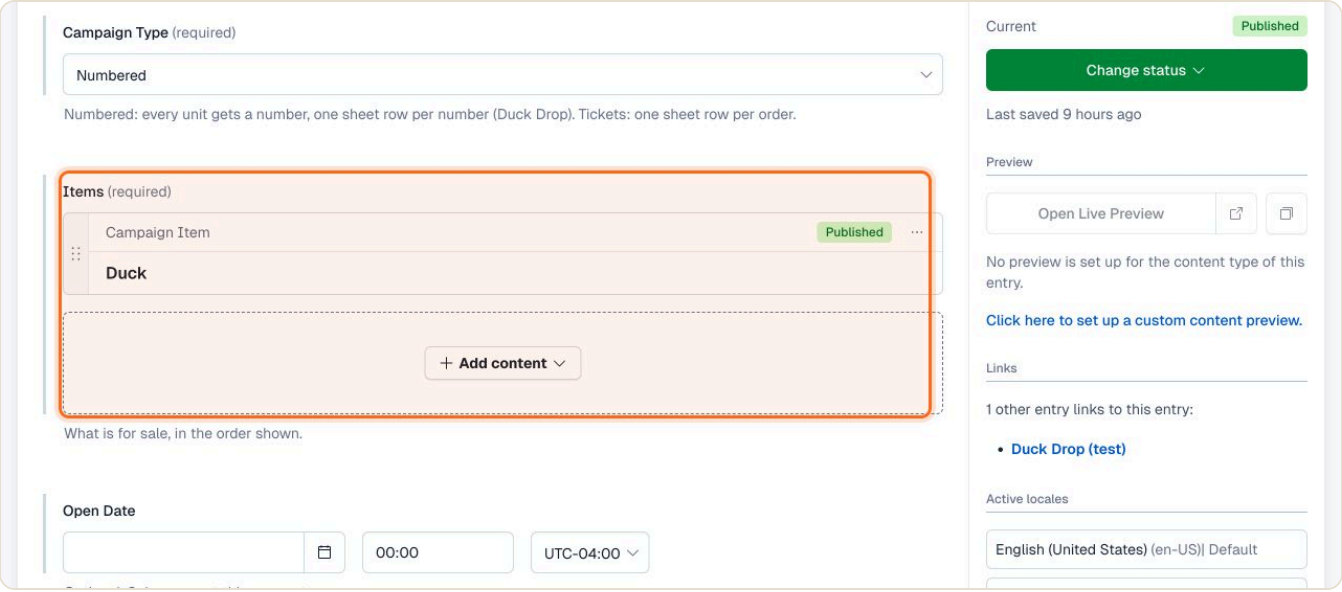
If you raise it later, the next duck jumps to the new number. Lowering it has no effect, so a number is never given out twice.



Start Number.

6 Items

Click **Add content → Add existing content** and pick the items you made in chapter 3. The order here is the order on the website; drag to rearrange.

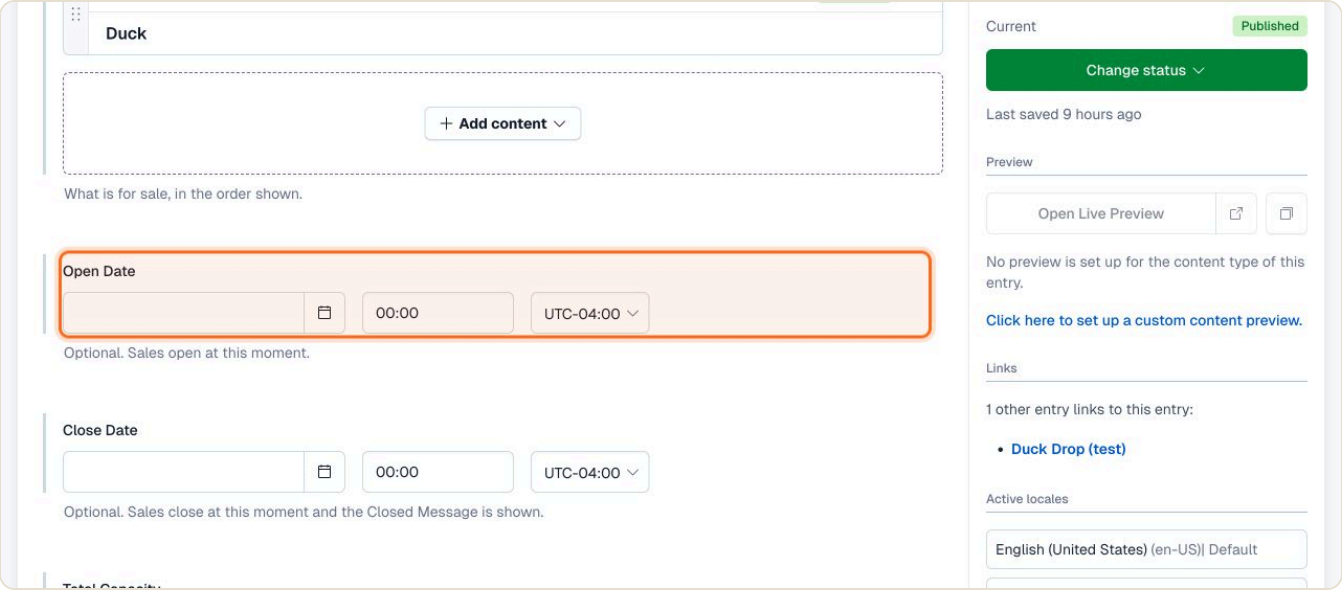


Items, linked to the Campaign Items.

7 Open and close dates (optional)

Open Date: sales start at this moment. **Close Date**: sales stop and visitors see the Closed Message instead of the form. Leave both empty to sell straight away with no end date.

> **Tip** Check the time zone next to each time. It should show Eastern time: **UTC-04:00** in summer, **UTC-05:00** in winter. Choose it from the list if it shows something else.



Open Date and Close Date.

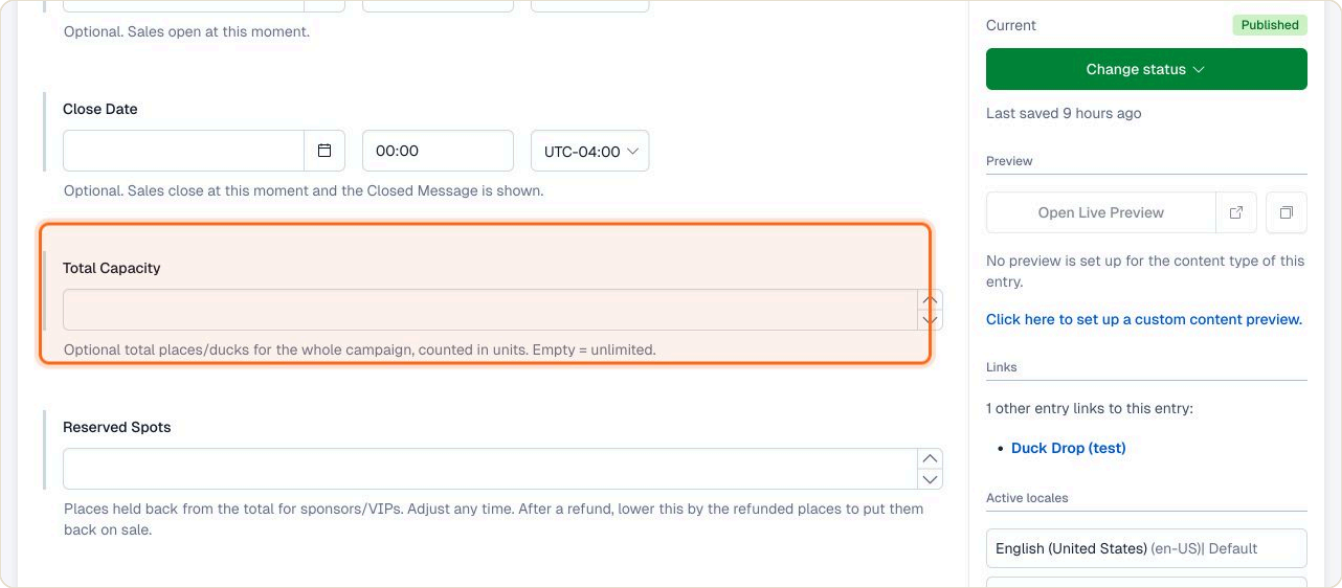
8 Limits (optional)

Total Capacity: how many ducks or people in total. For tickets this counts people, so a family ticket uses 4.

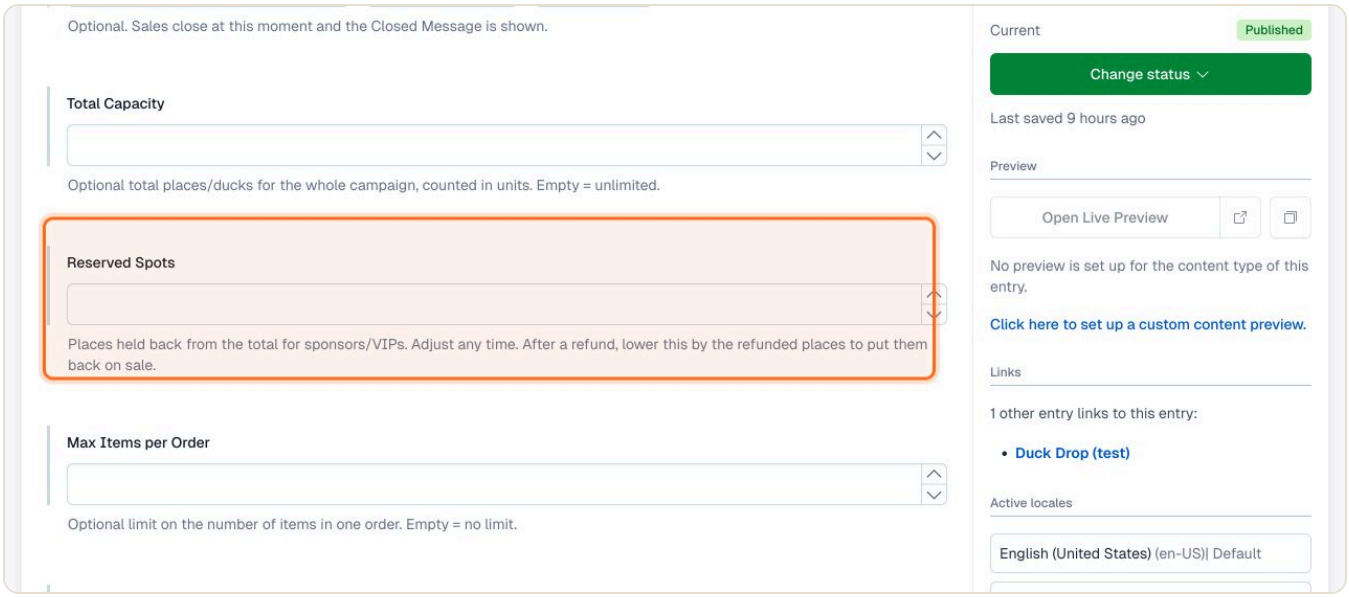
Reserved Spots: places held back from the total for sponsors, volunteers or VIPs who don't buy online. You can change this at any time.

Max Items per Order: the most items one buyer can take in one order.

Leave any of these empty for no limit. Example: a hall for 120 with 10 seats for sponsors → Total Capacity `120`, Reserved Spots `10`, so 110 are sold online.



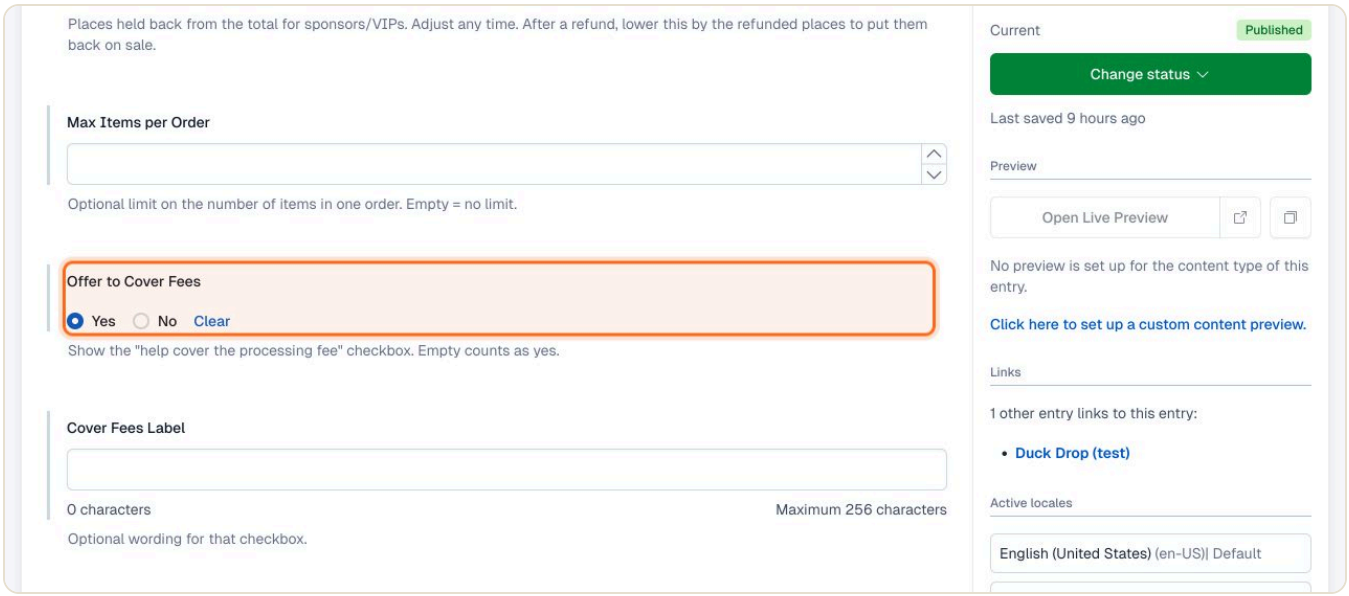
Total Capacity.



Reserved Spots.

9 Offer to cover fees

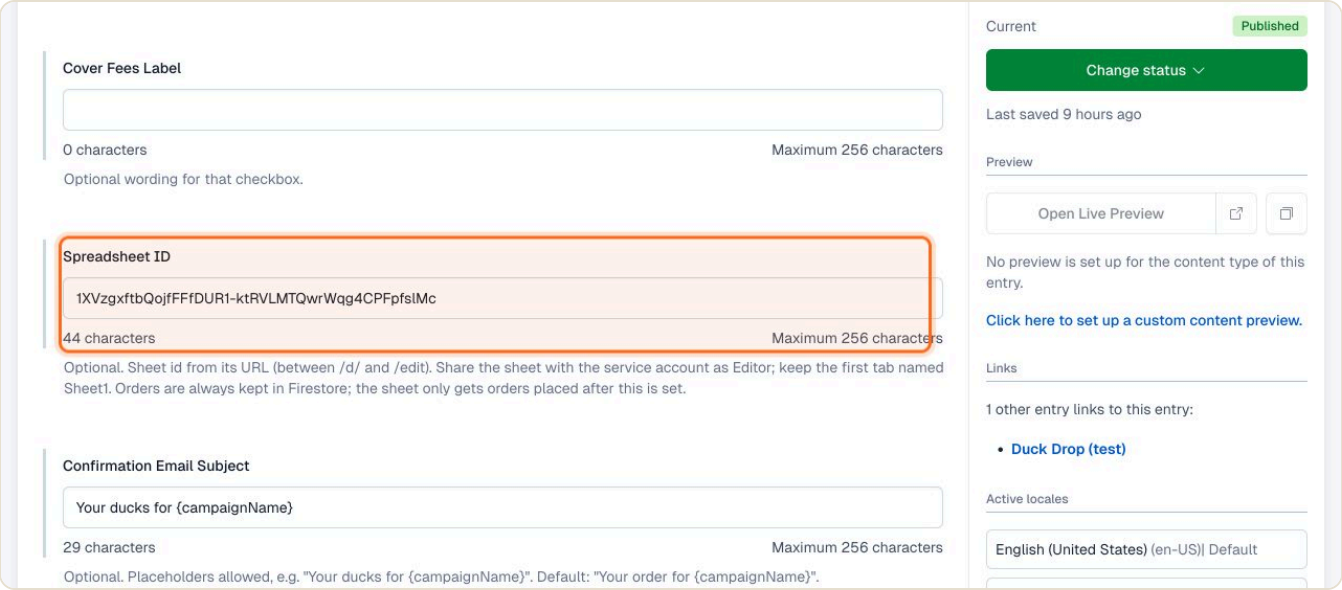
Turn on to show the checkbox "Help cover the credit card processing fee". Most buyers leave it ticked, so the pantry receives the full price. **Cover Fees Label** changes its wording.



Offer to Cover Fees.

10 Spreadsheet ID

Paste the ID you copied in chapter 2. Paste only the ID, not the whole link; Contentful will warn you if you paste a link.



Spreadsheet ID.

11 The confirmation email

Every buyer gets this email right after paying. Write it in the **Confirmation Email Subject** and **Confirmation Email Body** fields. Words in curly brackets are filled in for each buyer:

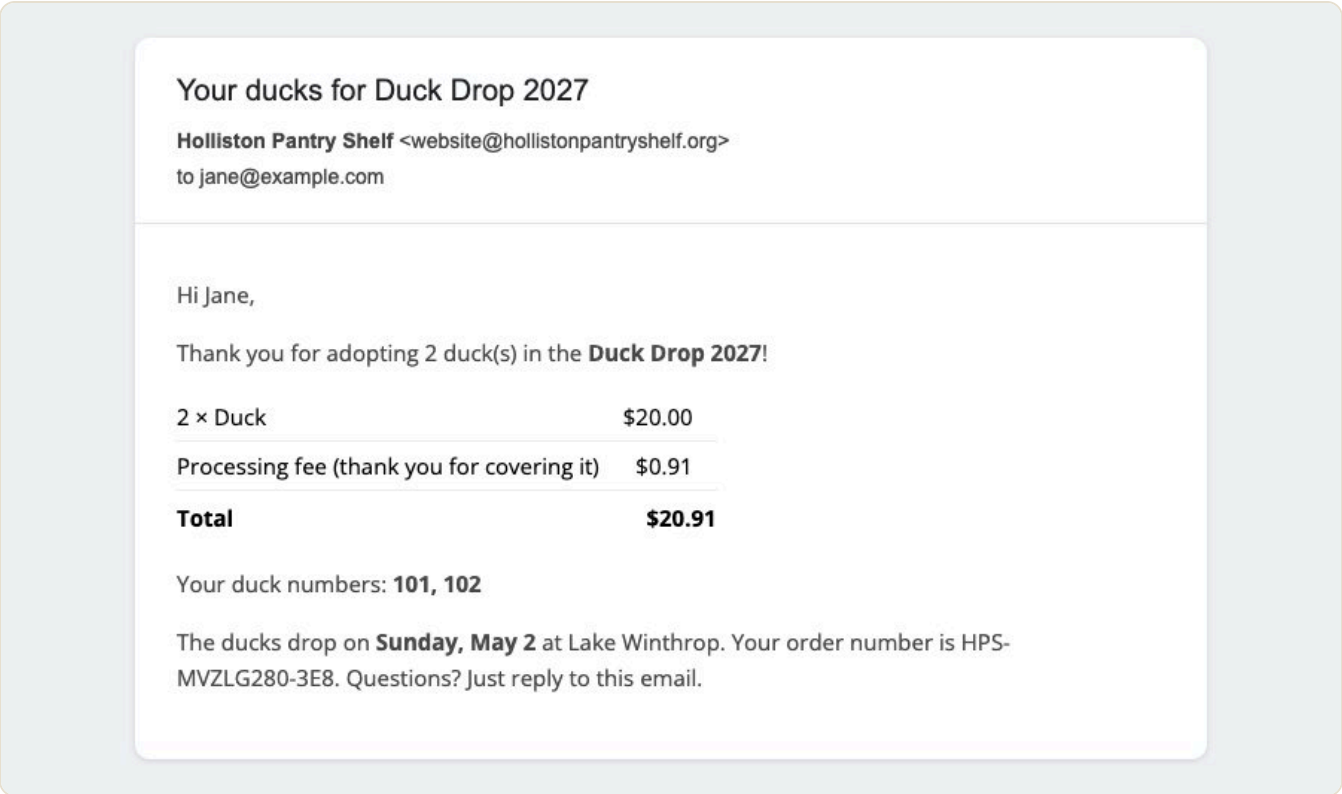
Write	Becomes	Example
{firstName}	Buyer's first name	Jane
{lastName}	Buyer's last name	Example
{campaignName}	The campaign's Name	Duck Drop 2027
{count}	How many ducks or places	2
{numbers}	Their duck numbers	101, 102
{total}	Amount paid	$20.91
{orderId}	Order number	HPS-MVZLG280-1A2B
{orderSummary}	A small table of what they bought, with the total. Put it on a line by itself.	(table)

Use ****double asterisks**** for bold and a blank line between paragraphs. If you leave the body empty, a short standard email is sent. For a Numbered campaign the duck numbers are always included, even if you forget `{numbers}`.

This is what the buyer receives:



The Confirmation Email Body field.

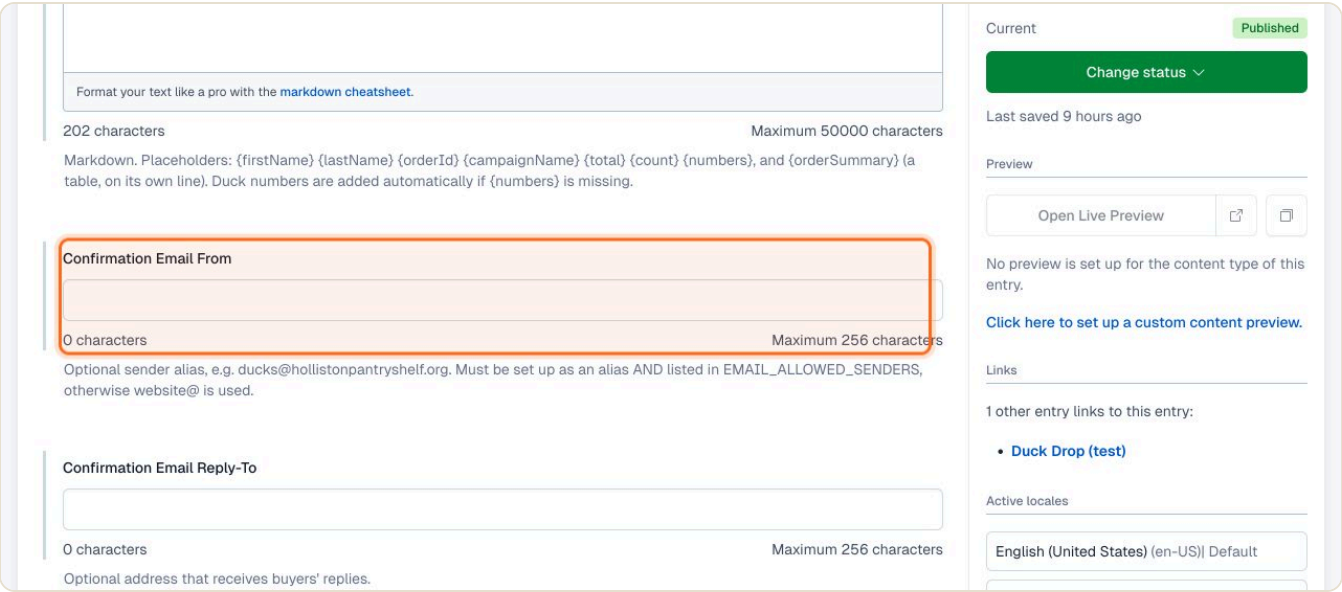


The email the buyer receives, built from that text.

12 Sender and replies (optional)

Confirmation Email From: leave empty to send from `website@hollistonpantryshelf.org`. A different sender, such as `ducks@`, must first be set up by the website administrator.

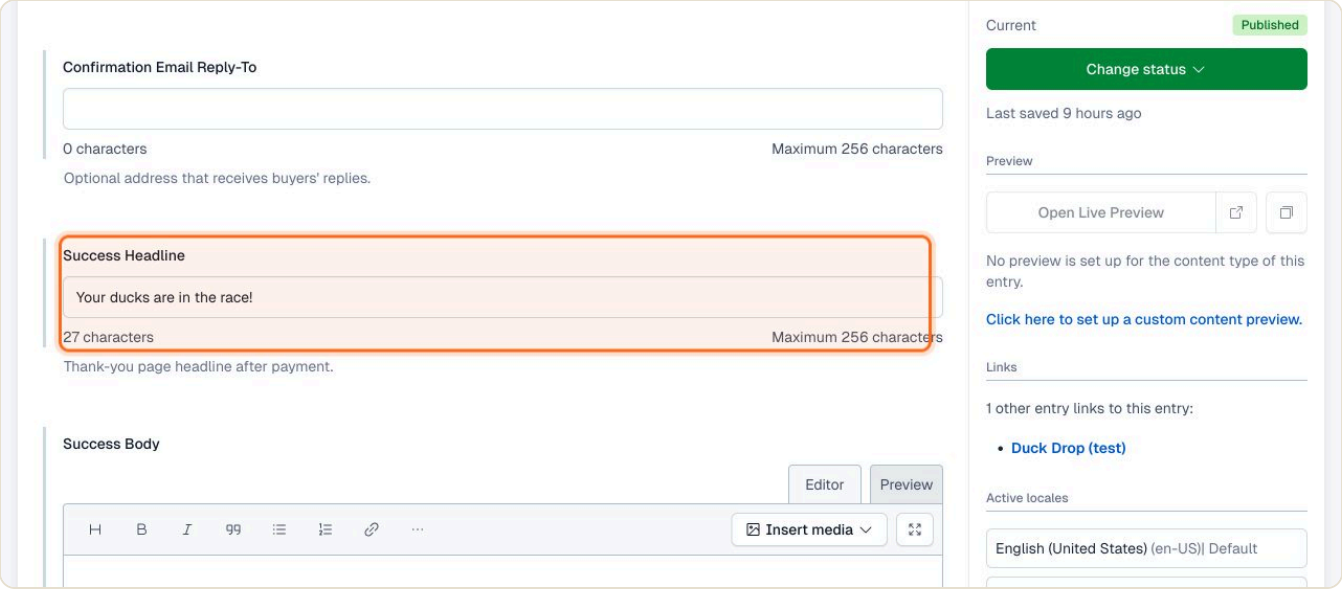
Confirmation Email Reply-To: where buyers' replies go, for example the event coordinator's address.



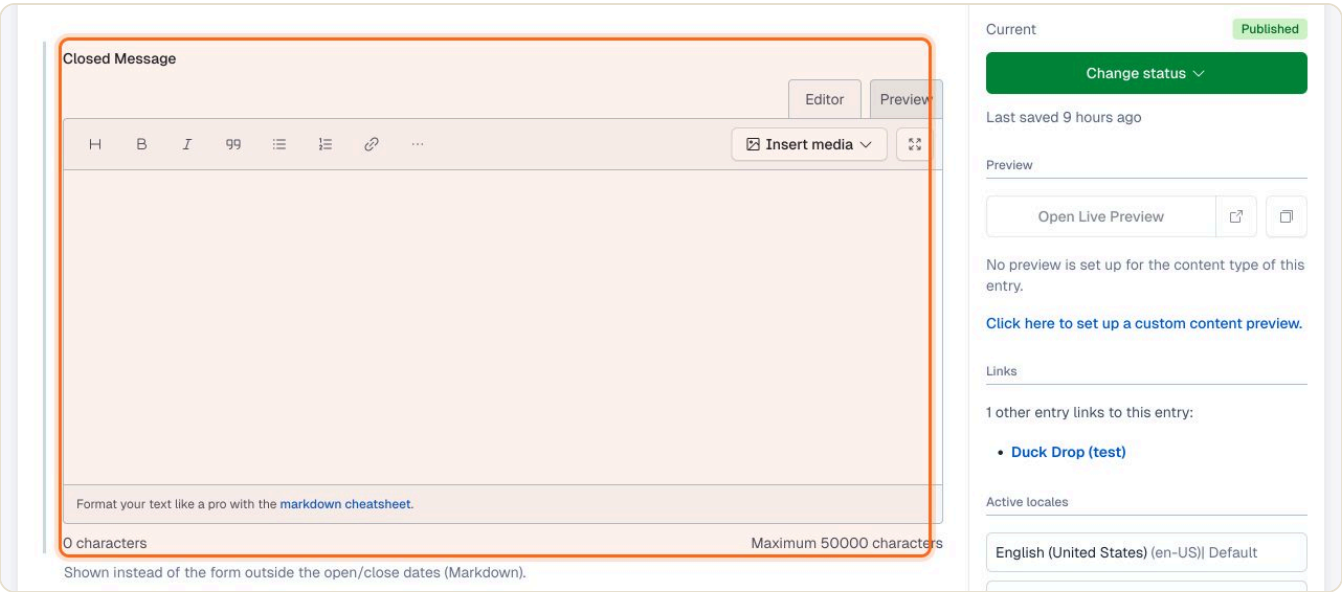
Confirmation Email From.

13 Messages on the website

Success Headline and **Success Body**: the thank-you page after payment.
Closed Message: shown instead of the form outside the open and close dates.
Sold Out Message: shown when everything is sold.



Success Headline and Body.



Closed Message.

14 Publish

Click **Publish**. The campaign is ready but not yet visible anywhere; that is the next chapter.

CONTENTFUL · 5 MINUTES

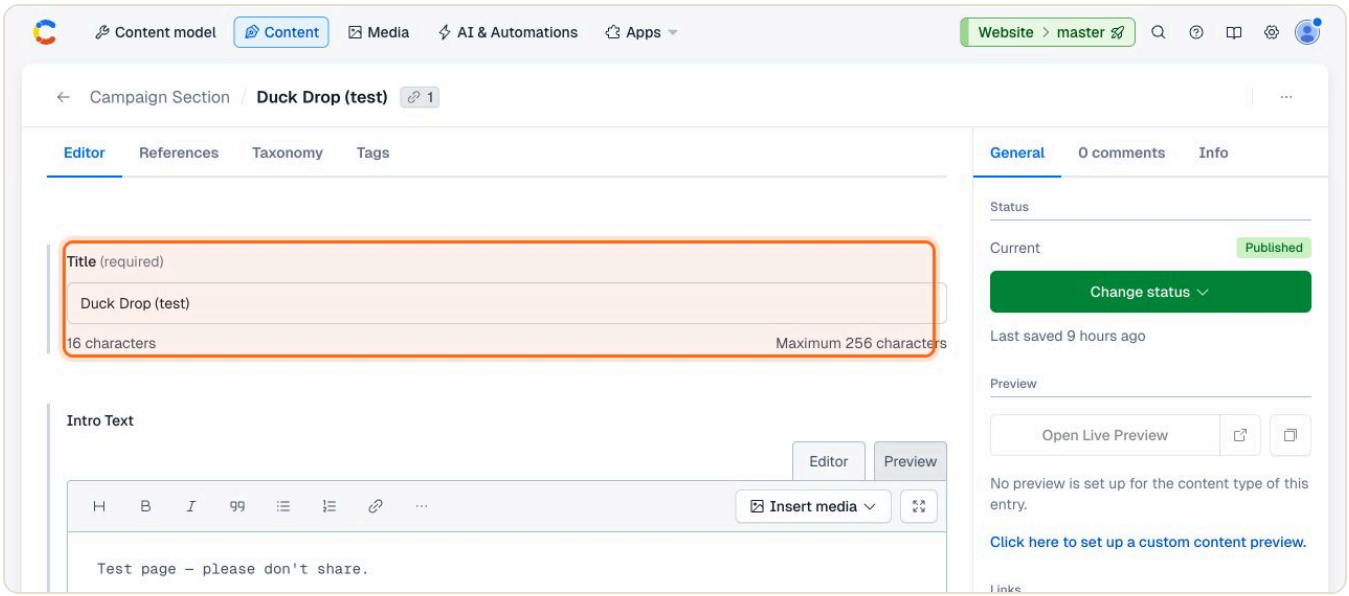
Put it on the website

A campaign appears on the website through a **Campaign Section** on a **Page**. You can give it a page of its own (best for the Duck Drop) or add it to an existing page.

A. Create the section

1 Add a Campaign Section

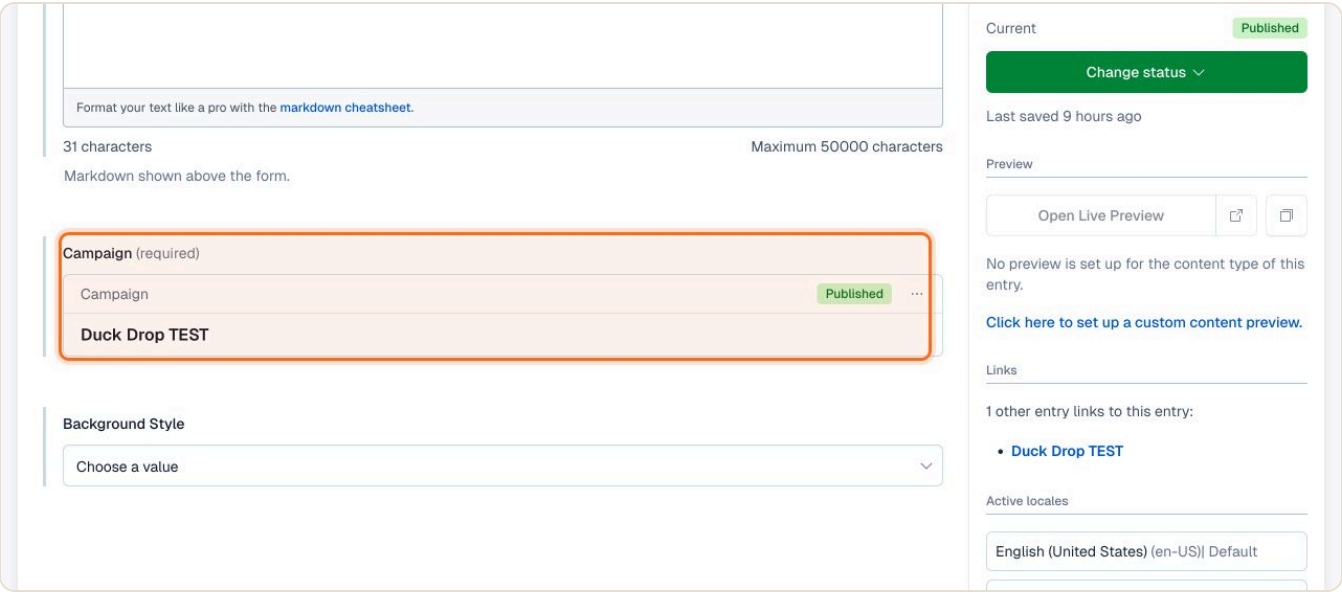
Content → Add entry → Campaign Section. Enter a **Title** (the heading on the page, such as "Adopt a Duck!") and an **Intro Text** explaining the event, the date and what buyers get.



Title.

2 Link the campaign

Under **Campaign**, click **Add content → Add existing content** and choose your campaign. Pick a **Background Style** if you like, then **Publish**.

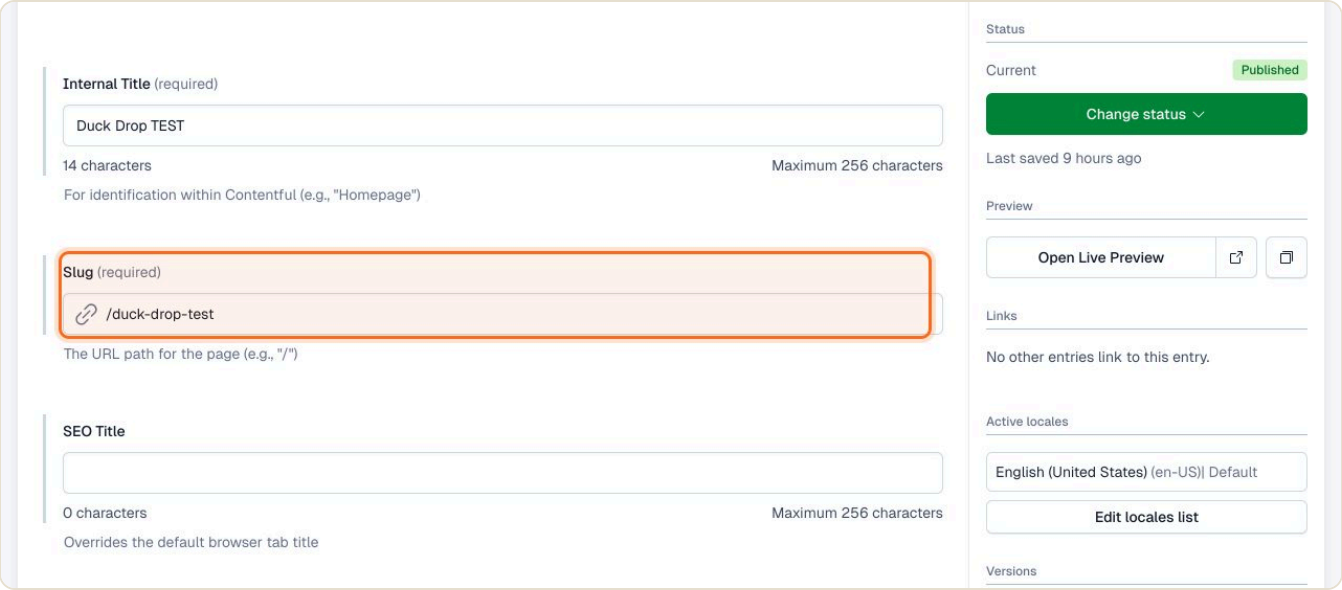


The Campaign field linked to the campaign.

B1. On a new page

3 Create the page

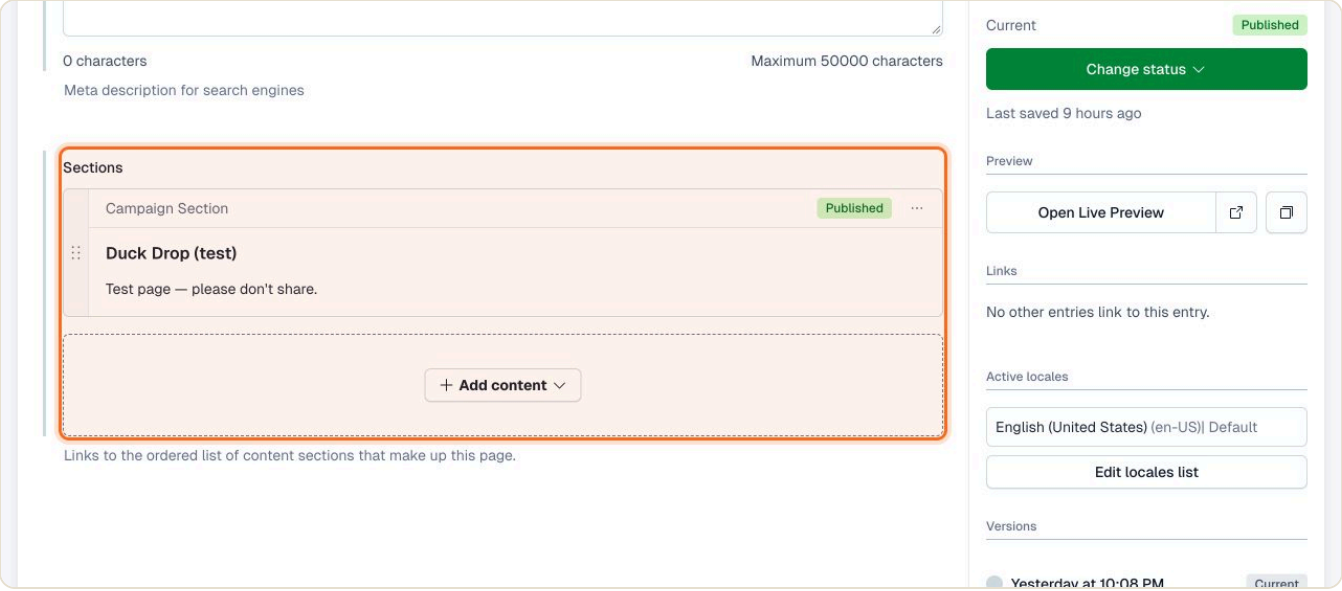
Content → Add entry → Page. Fill in an **Internal Title** and a **Slug**: the web address, starting with a slash, such as `/duck-drop`.



Slug.

4 Add the section

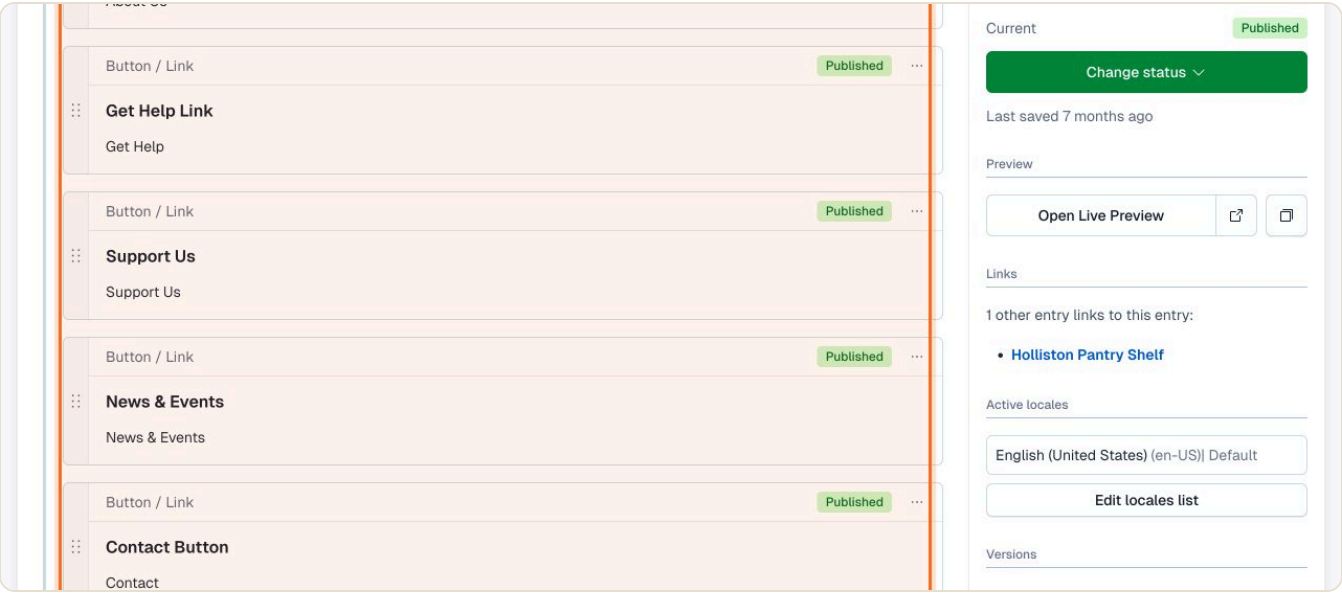
Under **Sections**, click **Add content → Add existing content**, choose the Campaign Section, then **Publish**. The page is now live at that address, but nobody can find it yet. Test it now (chapter 6) before you link to it.



Sections on the page.

5 Link to it from the menu (after testing)

Open the **Navigation Menu** entry, add a **Button / Link** under **Menu Items** with the text and the slug, and publish. Or link to the page from a button on the homepage or in the announcement bar.



Menu Items in the Navigation Menu.

B2. Or on an existing page

3 Add the section to the page

Open the page, for example *Support*. Under **Sections**, click **Add content → Add existing content**, choose the Campaign Section, drag it into place and **Publish**. It is visible to everyone immediately, so do this after testing.



Sections on an existing page.

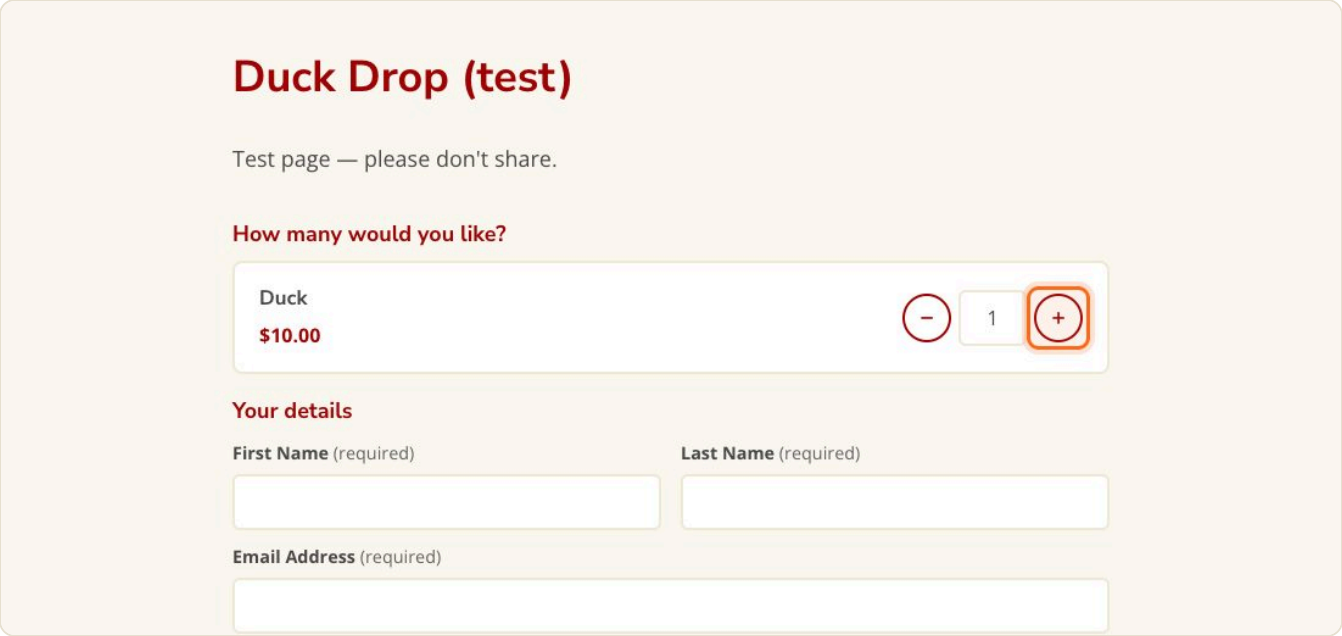
BEFORE YOU ANNOUNCE IT

Test it like a buyer

Open the page and walk through it exactly as a buyer would. This is also what you will see when you help someone over the phone.

1 Choose quantities

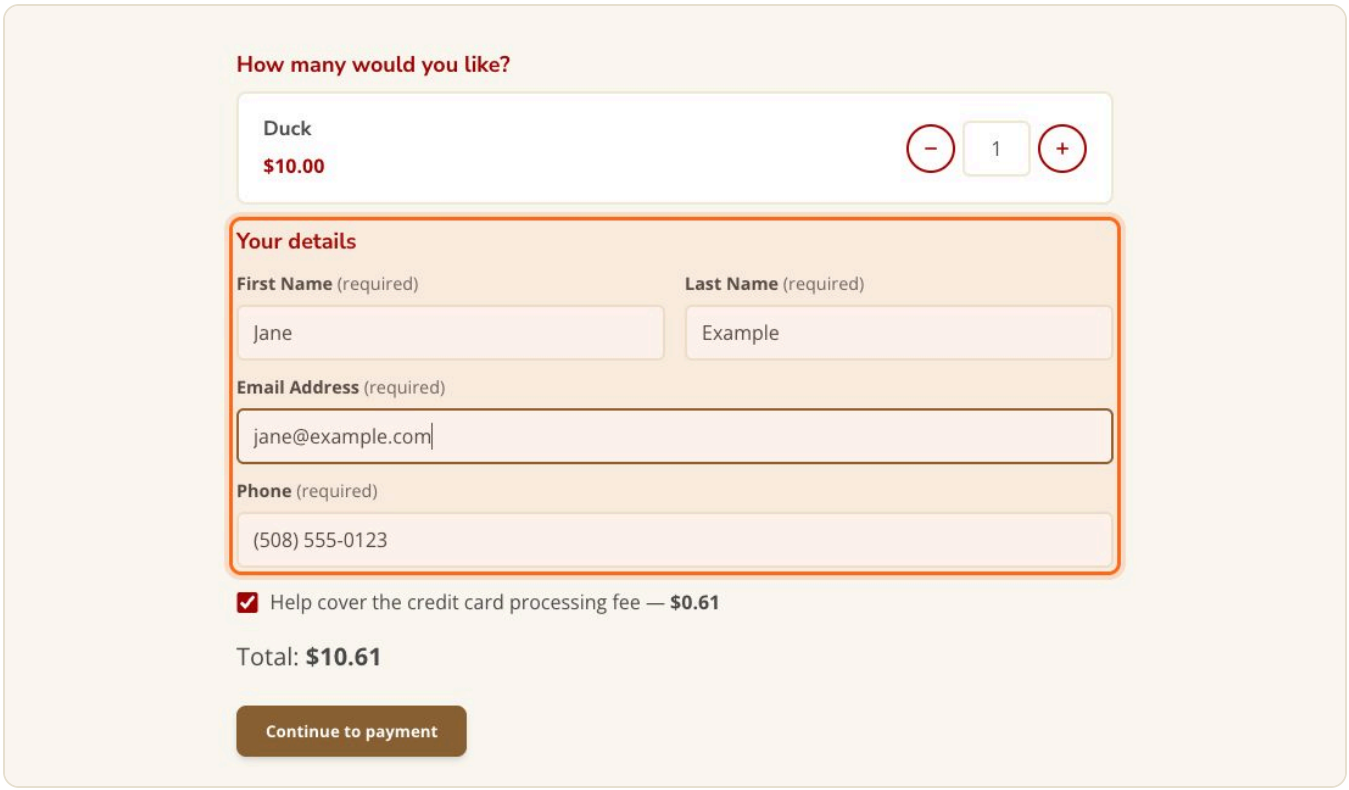
Use + and −, or type a number. The buttons stop at any limit you set.



Choosing how many.

2 Enter details

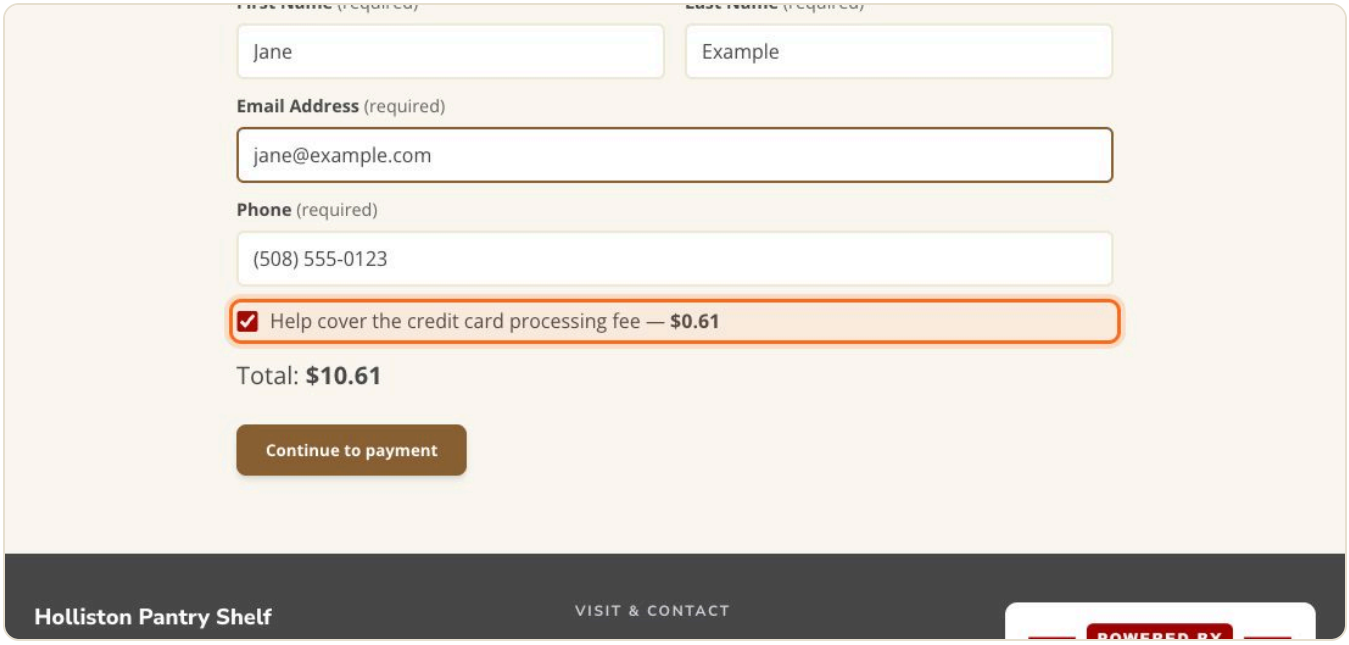
First and last name, email, and phone are all required. The phone number must be a US number; it is tidied up automatically, e.g. `(508) 555-0123`.



The buyer's details.

3 Check the fee and total

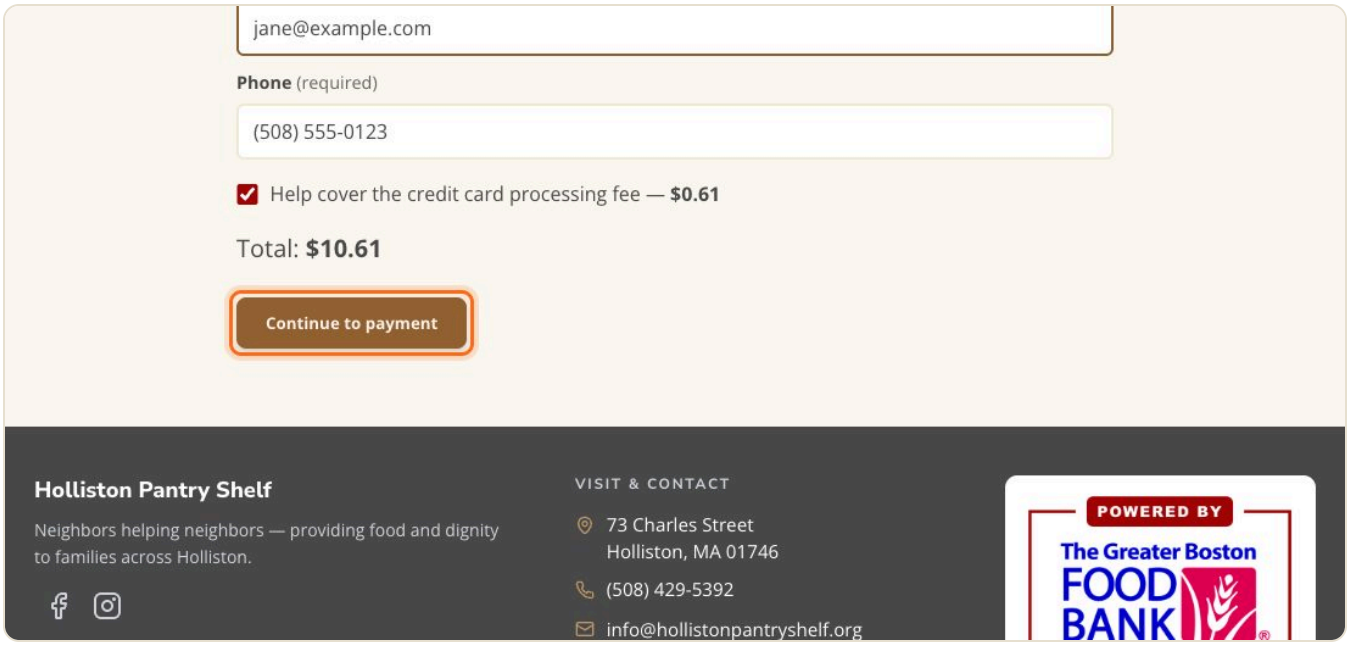
The fee checkbox is ticked by default. The total updates as you go.



Covering the processing fee.

4 Continue to payment

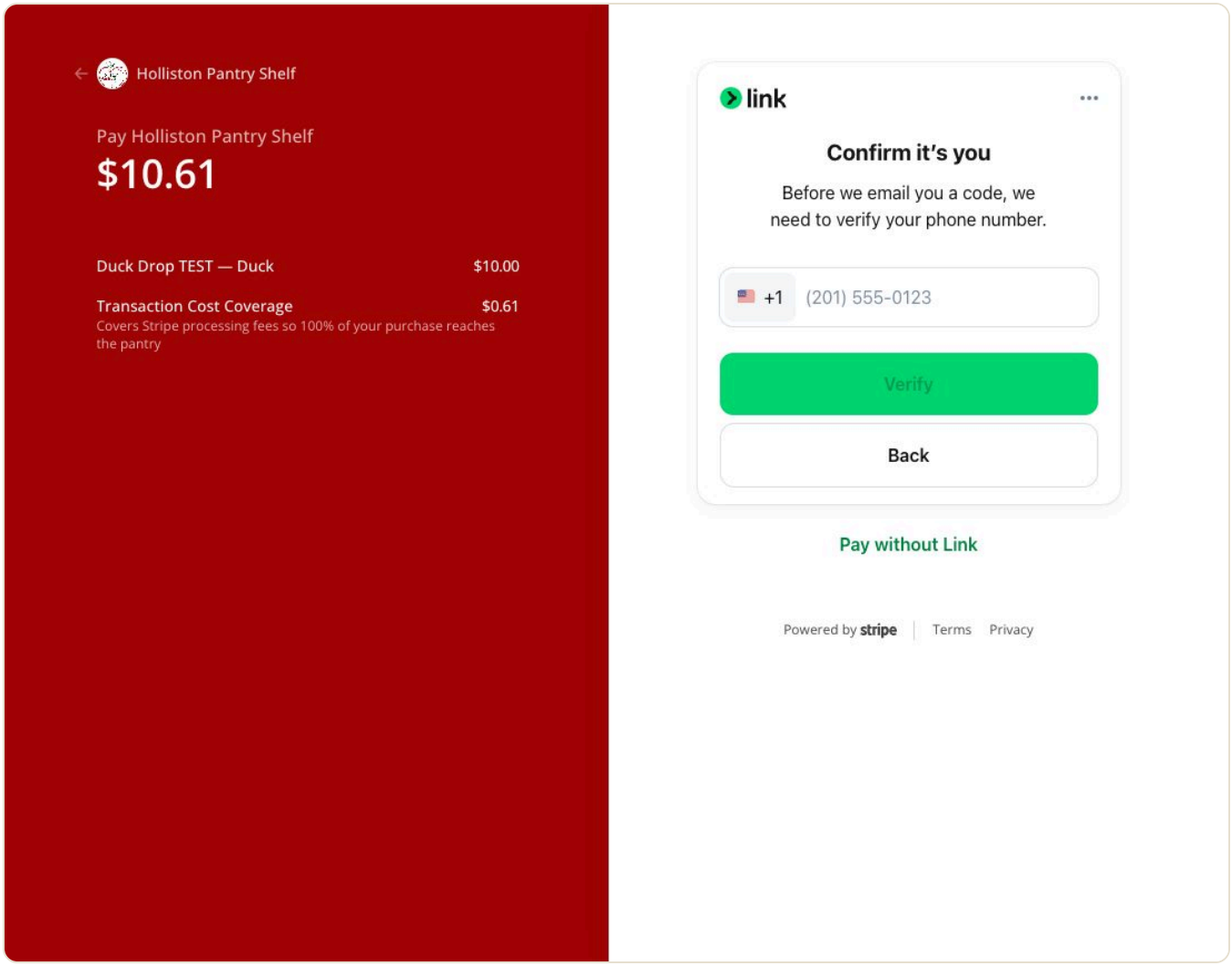
The buyer goes to Stripe's secure payment page. The items are reserved for them for 30 minutes while they pay.



Continue to payment.

5 Pay on Stripe

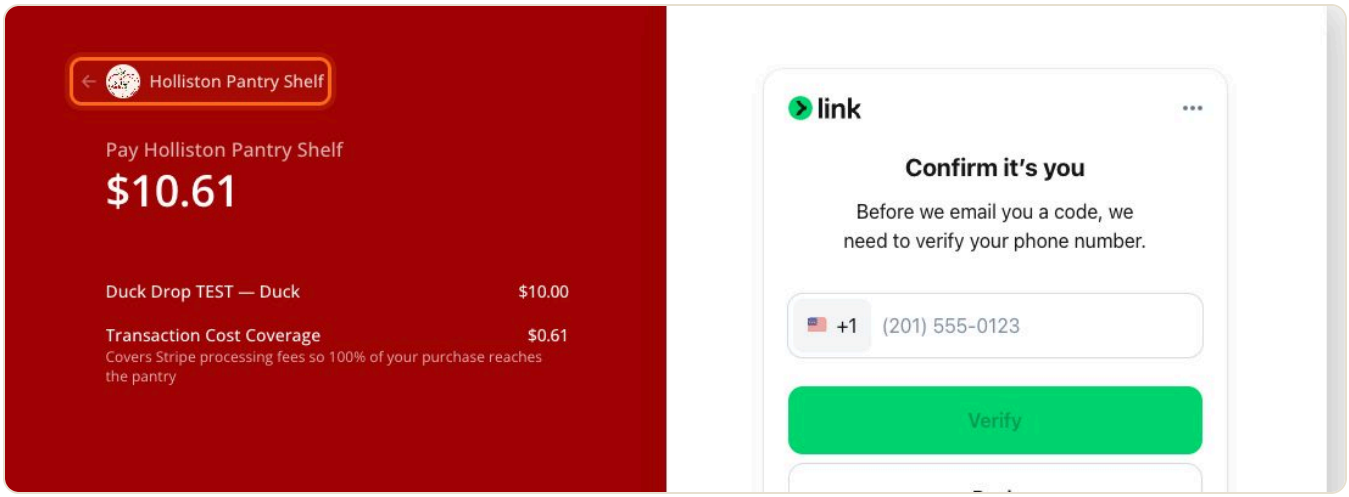
Stripe shows the pantry's name, each item and the total. Stripe sometimes offers its quick-pay service "Link" first; buyers can click **Pay without Link** to pay normally by card.



Stripe's payment page.

6 Changed their mind?

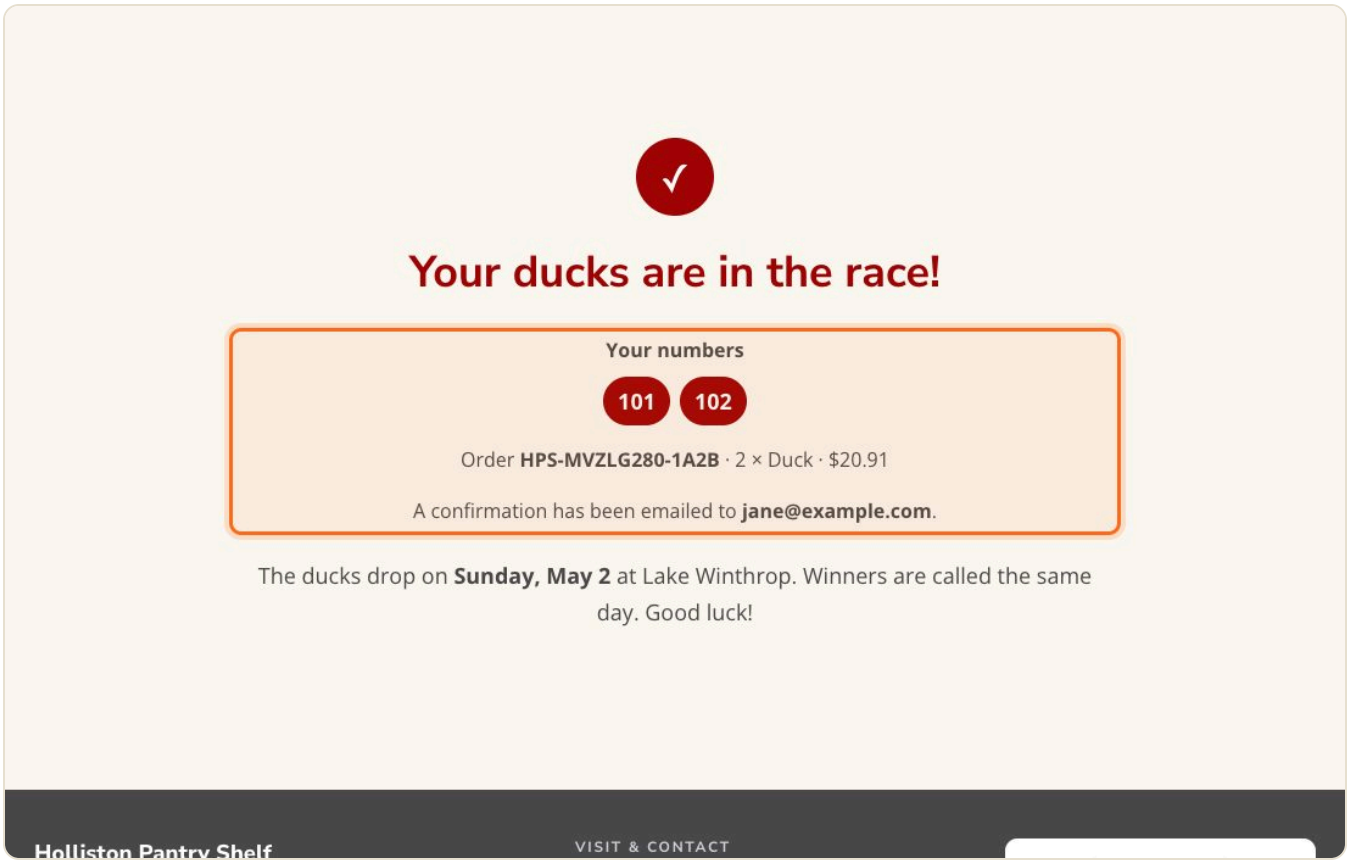
The back arrow at the top left returns to the form and releases the reserved items straight away.



Going back without paying.

7 Thank-you page

After paying, the buyer returns to the same page and sees your thank-you message, their order number, and for the Duck Drop their duck numbers.



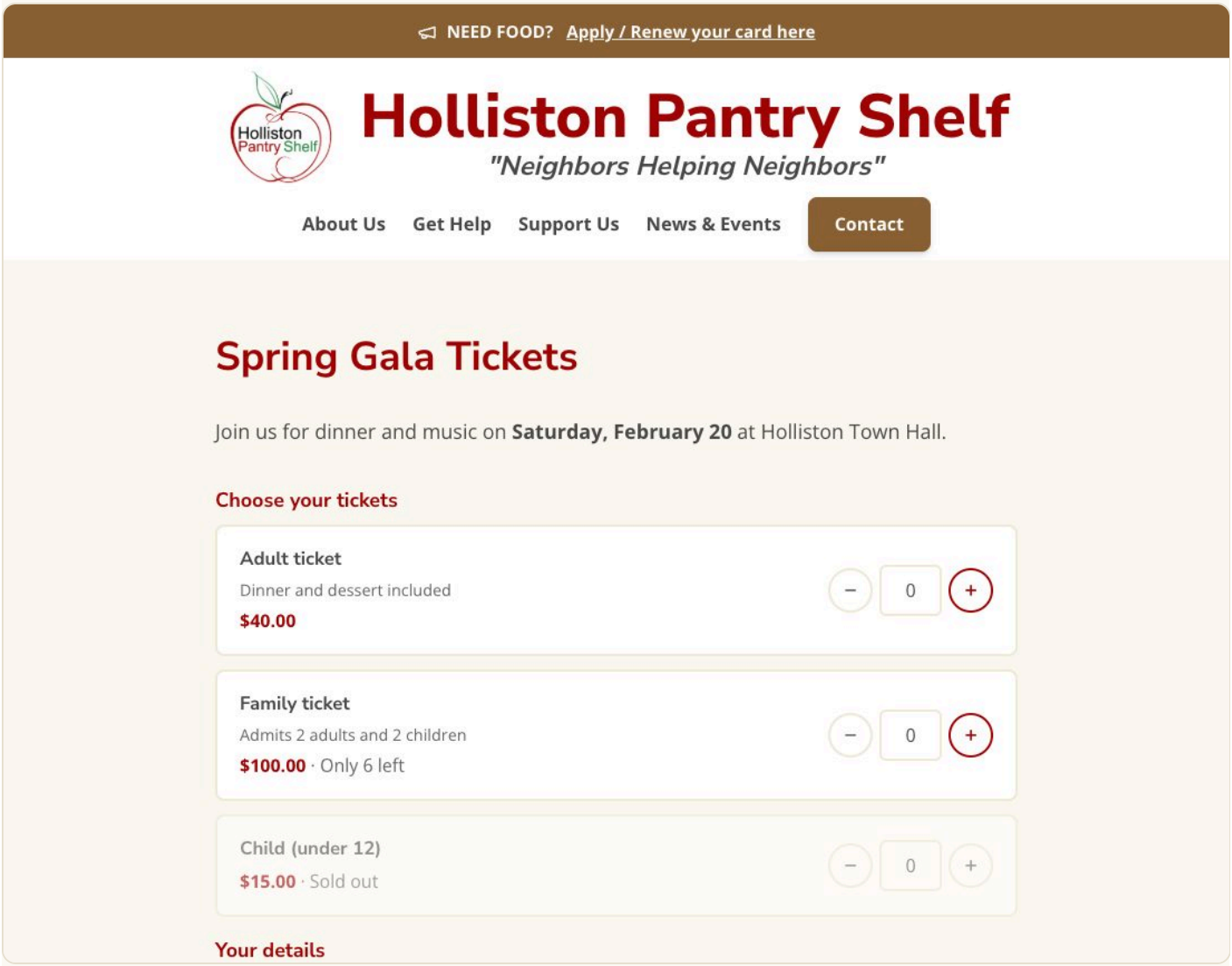
After payment: numbers and order details.

8 Confirmation email

Within a minute the email from chapter 4 arrives (check the spam folder the first time). The sale also appears in the spreadsheet.

Important **Do one real test purchase** of the cheapest item before you announce the campaign, then refund it in Stripe (chapter 8). It is the only way to be sure the payment, the email and the sheet all work. The refund costs the pantry Stripe's small fee, about 60 cents.

A ticket campaign looks like this



Tickets: several items, "Only 6 left", and a sold-out item.

WHILE SALES ARE OPEN

View sales and make changes

See who bought what

Open the campaign's spreadsheet. A new row appears within a minute of each payment. Sort or filter it like any sheet. Don't move or delete the generated columns; add your own to the right, such as "Checked in" or "Prize".

Duck Drop: one row per duck. Column C is the duck number, so on the day you can look up any number instantly.

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L
1	Date (ET)	Order ID	Number	Item	First Name	Last Name	Email	Phone	Numbers in Order	Order Total Paid (USD)	Fees Covered	Stripe Session ID
2	2027-04-02 10:00	HPS-MVZLG280-3E8	101	Duck	Jane	Example	jane@example.com	(508) 555-0123	2	20.91	Yes	cs_live_a1B2c3D4e50
3	2027-04-02 10:00	HPS-MVZLG280-3E8	102	Duck	Jane	Example	jane@example.com	(508) 555-0123	2	20.91	Yes	cs_live_a1B2c3D4e50
4	2027-04-02 10:09	HPS-MVZLG289-427	103	5-pack	Sam	Rivera	sam.rivera@example.com	(508) 555-0177	5	41.51	Yes	cs_live_a1B2c3D4e59
5	2027-04-02 10:09	HPS-MVZLG289-427	104	5-pack	Sam	Rivera	sam.rivera@example.com	(508) 555-0177	5	41.51	Yes	cs_live_a1B2c3D4e59
6	2027-04-02 10:09	HPS-MVZLG289-427	105	5-pack	Sam	Rivera	sam.rivera@example.com	(508) 555-0177	5	41.51	Yes	cs_live_a1B2c3D4e59
7	2027-04-02 10:09	HPS-MVZLG289-427	106	5-pack	Sam	Rivera	sam.rivera@example.com	(508) 555-0177	5	41.51	Yes	cs_live_a1B2c3D4e59
8	2027-04-02 10:09	HPS-MVZLG289-427	107	5-pack	Sam	Rivera	sam.rivera@example.com	(508) 555-0177	5	41.51	Yes	cs_live_a1B2c3D4e59
9	2027-04-02 10:23	HPS-MVZLG303-489	108	Duck	Lee	Chen	lee.chen@example.com	(774) 555-0142	1	10.61	Yes	cs_live_a1B2c3D4e523

Duck Drop sheet: Jane bought 2 ducks, Sam a 5-pack (numbers 103–107), Lee 1.

Tickets: one row per order. The *People* column (H) counts family tickets as 4.

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M
1	Date (ET)	Order ID	First Name	Last Name	Email	Phone	Order	People	Subtotal (USD)	Fee Covered (USD)	Total Paid (USD)	Fair Market Value (USD)	Stripe Ses
2	2027-01-12 10:00	HPS-MW01K100-7D0	Jane	Example	jane@example.com	(508) 555-0123	2 × Adult ticket	2	80	2.7	82.7	50	cs_live_Z9
3	2027-01-12 10:14	HPS-MW01K114-7DE	Sam	Rivera	sam.rivera@example.com	(508) 555-0177	1 × Family ticket, 1 × Adult ticket	5	140	4.5	144.5	85	cs_live_Z9

Ticket sheet: one row per order, with the number of people.

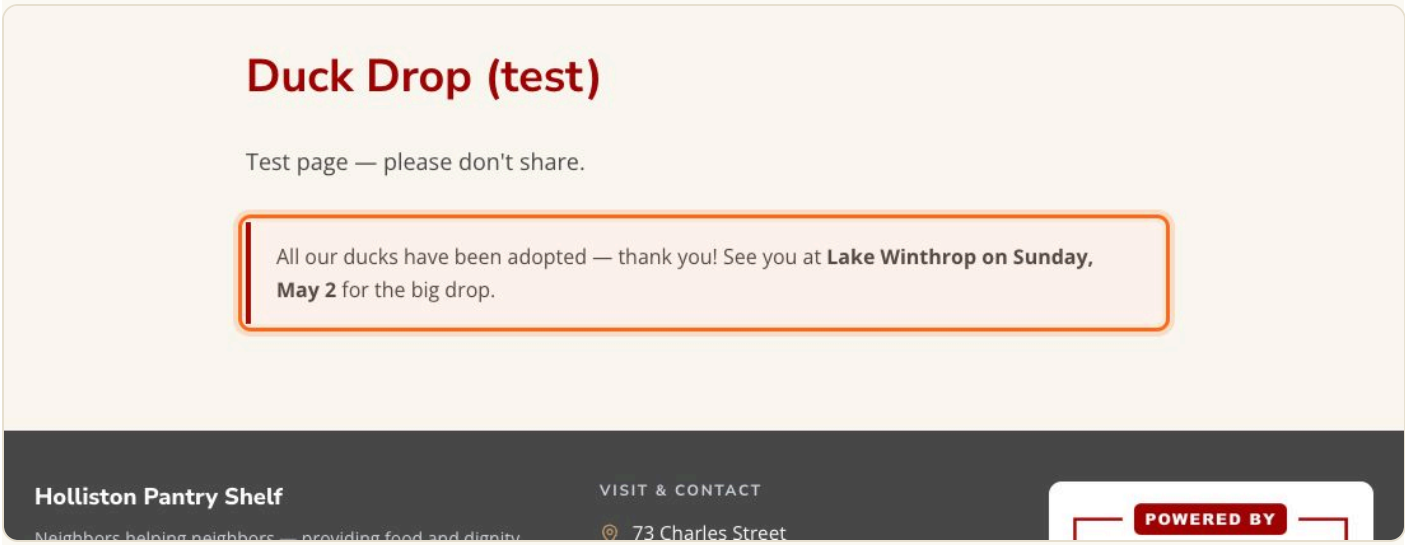
To find out	In the sheet
Ducks sold so far	The highest number in column C, or `=COUNTA(C2:C)`
People coming (tickets)	`=SUM(H2:H)`
Money raised	Use Stripe's dashboard (it shows refunds too), or add up each order once
Someone's order	Search the sheet (Ctrl/⌘ F) for their name or email

How much is left

When an item has a limit, the website shows **Only N left** once 20 or fewer remain, and **Sold out** at zero. When everything is gone, the Sold Out Message replaces the form.



"Only 7 left" appears automatically.

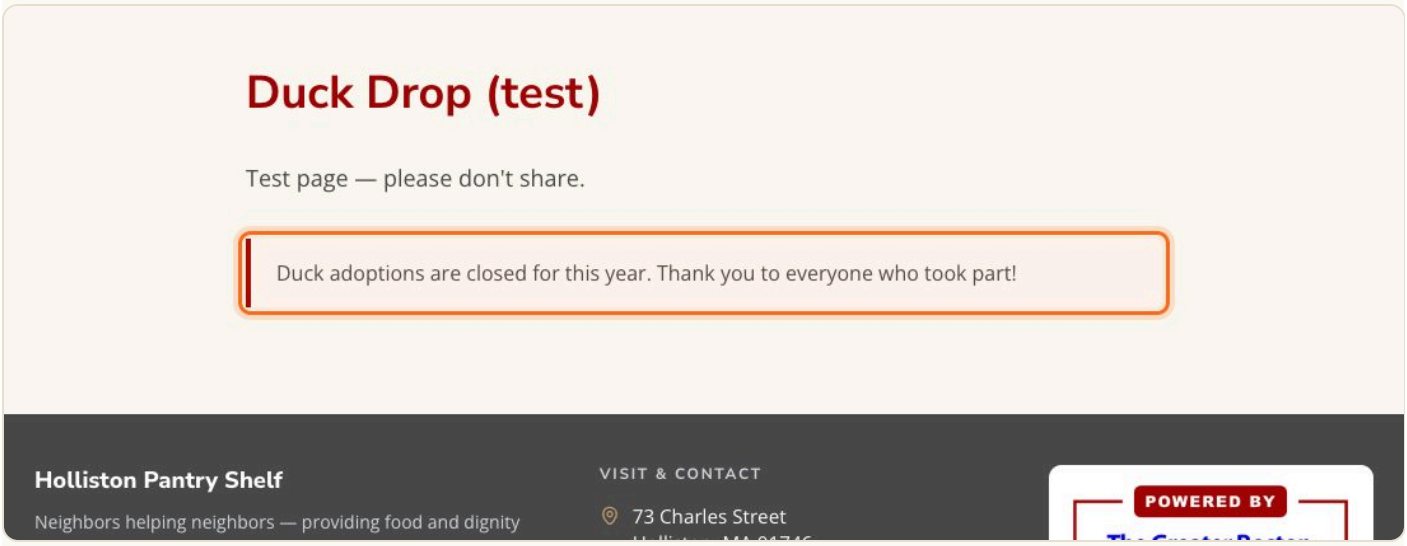


The Sold Out Message, written in the campaign.

Common changes

You want to...	Do this in the campaign (then Publish)
Hold back more places for sponsors	Raise **Reserved Spots**. Lower it to release them for sale.
Sell more than planned	Raise **Total Capacity** (or the item's Total Available).

You want to...	Do this in the campaign (then Publish)
Stop sales now	Set **Close Date** to now. Visitors see the Closed Message.
Extend sales	Move the **Close Date** later.
Change the email or messages	Edit them. New buyers get the new text straight away.
Change a price	Edit the item's Price. Only new orders pay the new price.
Add an item (e.g. a 10-pack)	Create the Campaign Item and add it to **Items**.



After the Close Date, the Closed Message replaces the form.

> **Tip** Changes in Contentful reach the website within about a minute. Refresh the page to see them.

HELPING BUYERS

Refunds and buyer questions

Refunds are done in Stripe by someone with access to the pantry's Stripe account (usually the treasurer).

1 Find the payment

Go to **dashboard.stripe.com → Payments** and search for the buyer's email address. The payment description includes the campaign name and order number, such as *Duck Drop 2027 — HPS-MVZLG280-1A2B*.

2 Refund it

Open the payment, click **Refund**, choose the full amount or part of it, pick a reason and confirm. The buyer gets the money back in 5–10 days. Stripe keeps its small processing fee.

3 Mark it in the sheet

Add a column on the right called **Refunded** and mark the buyer's row(s). Don't delete the rows: they are your record of what happened.

4 Give the places back (only if the campaign has a limit)

The website still counts a refunded order as sold. To put the places back on sale, lower **Reserved Spots** by that many (a family ticket = 4). If Reserved Spots is already 0, raise **Total Capacity** instead. Refunded duck numbers are not reused.

Questions you may get

Buyer says...	What to do
"I didn't get my email."	Find them in the sheet. If the row is there, the payment worked: ask them to check spam, and send their order number and duck numbers from your own email. If there is no row, check Stripe; if Stripe shows no payment, they did not complete checkout.
"I made a typo in my name or email."	Correct it in the sheet. Nothing else needs to change.
"Can I swap my duck numbers?"	No. Numbers are given in order of purchase and can't be changed.
"It says sold out but I need tickets."	If you have Reserved Spots left, sell them directly and lower Reserved Spots, or release some for online sale.
"The form won't accept my phone number."	It must be a US number with area code, e.g. 508 555 0123.

WHEN IT IS OVER

Close the campaign

1 Stop sales

Set the **Close Date** (if you didn't already) and publish. The Closed Message shows from then on.

2 Remove the links

After the event, remove the menu link and any buttons pointing to the page. Then either unpublish the page or remove the section from it.

3 Keep the records

Don't delete the Campaign entry or the spreadsheet; they are the record of the event. Move the sheet into an archive folder if you like.

4 Next year

Make a **new** Campaign with a new Campaign ID (`duck-drop-2028`) and a new spreadsheet. You can reuse the items. Never reuse an old Campaign ID: it would continue last year's numbering and counts.

COPY THESE

Ready-made examples

Duck Drop

Field	Value
Items	"Duck" $10 · "5-pack of ducks" $40, Units per Item 5
Name / Campaign ID	Duck Drop 2027 / `duck-drop-2027`
Campaign Type	Numbered
Start Number	empty, or the first number after the paper sales
Open / Close Date	April 1, 9:00 AM / May 1, 11:59 PM
Total Capacity	empty (unlimited), or the number of ducks you have
Email subject	`Your ducks for {campaignName}`
Success Headline	Your ducks are in the race!

Email body:

```
Hi {firstName},

Thank you for adopting {count} duck(s) in the **{campaignName}**!

{orderSummary}

Your duck numbers: **{numbers}**

The ducks drop on **Sunday, May 2 at 2 PM** at Lake Winthrop. Winners are called the
same day.
Your order number is {orderId}. Questions? Just reply to this email.
```

Dinner or gala tickets

Field	Value
Items	"Adult ticket" $40, Fair Market Value 25 · "Family ticket" $100, Units per Item 4, Fair Market Value 60
Name / Campaign ID	Spring Gala 2027 / `spring-gala-2027`
Campaign Type	Tickets
Total Capacity / Reserved Spots	120 / 10
Max Items per Order	8
Email subject	`Your tickets for {campaignName}`

Email body:

```
Hi {firstName},

Thank you! You're coming to the **{campaignName}**.

{orderSummary}

**Saturday, February 20 · doors at 6 PM · Holliston Town Hall**
There are no paper tickets: we'll have your name at the door.
Your order number is {orderId}.
```

> **Tip** With a Fair Market Value set, the email automatically ends with the tax statement, for example: "We estimate that value at $50.00, so $30.00 of your $80.00 payment may be deductible."

TROUBLESHOOTING

If something looks wrong

What you see	Likely cause and fix
The page shows the title but no form	The campaign or its items are not published, or no item has a price. Publish them all.
"Sales are currently closed" before the start	The Open Date is in the future or the Close Date has passed. Check both, including the time and AM/PM.
"This campaign could not be found"	The campaign is unpublished, or its Campaign ID was changed. Change it back and publish.
A buyer paid but the sheet has no row	The sheet ID is missing or wrong, the sheet is not shared with the website as Editor, or the first tab was renamed. Fix it and tell the website administrator: earlier sales can be recovered.
Columns in the sheet are shifted	Someone inserted or moved a column. Move it back; new rows always follow the original order.
No confirmation emails	Check the website@ mailbox's Sent folder, then contact the website administrator.
Changes in Contentful don't show	Did you click Publish? Wait a minute and refresh.

For anything else, contact the website administrator with the campaign name, the buyer's email and the time of purchase.

Questions about this guide or the website? Ask the website administrator.